Bedding Market Entry Feasibility — Consolidated Report

Amazon US, Canada and UK · Pakistan-based manufacturer · new brand

Inspiratek & Ecotero · consolidates Study A (internal-account-led) and Study B (Independent Bedding Market Intelligence)

26 October 2026

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How to read this consolidated report

This report merges two studies completed on 26 October 2026 into one decision document. Both answer the same brief — should a Pakistan-based manufacturer launch a new bedding brand on Amazon US, Canada and the UK — from different evidence bases.

	Study A — internal-account-led feasibility	Study B — Independent Bedding Market Intelligence
Evidence base	37 months of Sellerboard P&L, Ecotero Command Center PPC and unit economics for 18 bedding products, 27 Data Dive niches, Keepa, Brand Analytics, the SLQS quilt audit, and desk research on fees, duties and markets	33 live Amazon query pages (11 per marketplace), 1,627 listing observations, 15 product detail captures, 122 customer review cards, official fee/label/import pages, publisher market estimates, Dunelm FY2026 report
Deliberately excluded	—	Existing account data, so the screen stays product-agnostic
Gaps it could not close	Live UK listings, review text, official pages (blocked)	Search volumes, CPC/CVR benchmarks, competitor sales estimates, domestic US/UK postcode panels
Headline	Conditional go: US cotton percale launch with gates	Evidence-gathering only: five feasibility tracks, none investment-ready
Deliverables	Doc, 20-tab workbook, 8 charts, model and data	23-page report, 20-tab workbook, 6 charts, memo, evidence archive

Evidence labels. Study A uses ACTUAL (our accounts), CALC, EST (third party) and ASSUMPTION. Study B uses FACT, CLAIM (what a seller states), ESTIMATE, CALC, ASSUMPTION and GAP. They map one to one except that Study B separates seller CLAIMS from FACTS, and Study A has internal ACTUALS that Study B did not use. Figures from Study B are marked "[Study B]" and keep its source codes (M01, R22, LIVE_UK_sheets and so on, listed in the Sources section).

Currency and dates. USD unless marked; Canada in CAD and UK in GBP where stated. Internal primary window: 1 January – 26 October 2026. All external sources accessed 26 October 2026.

Consolidated decision

Decision: conditional, staged go. Both studies independently rank wash-tested 100% cotton percale with verified post-wash fit as a top opportunity and both reject commodity microfiber, waterproof protectors and bulky toppers. Study A's account data adds what Study B lacked — keyword demand, CPC and conversion benchmarks, review barriers and real landed costs — and shows the US pre-washed cotton niche is enterable at a 29.8% break-even ACoS. Study B adds what Study A lacked — live UK and Canadian listings, review text and official fee pages — and shows that nothing should be produced at scale until supplier quotes, wash tests and a capped pilot exist. The consolidated plan therefore keeps Study A's product and market choice and Study B's evidence gates.

1. **Stage 0 — evidence, weeks 1–6 (about $10–20k):** mill cost sheets and two comparable supplier quotes; pre-production samples; accredited wash, shrinkage, pilling and colour-fastness tests; broker, freight, FBA/3PL quotes; a matched blind comparison against LANE LINEN, California Design Den and MooMee samples; domestic US/UK postcode panels. Run Study B's top idea — UK hospitality/private-label white cotton-rich linen — as a parallel, Amazon-free B2B track using the same samples (sample packs and buyer quotes only).

2. **Stage 1 — capped US pilot (Gate 1 passed):** pre-washed cotton percale 4-piece sets, Full/Queen/King, four colours, 12 SKUs, $59.99–69.99. Capital between Study B's medium case ($55k, 800 units, $8k ads) and Study A's base ($130k, 2,500 units, $35k ads); Study A's low case ($72k, 1,500 units, $20k ads) is the practical floor for a 12-SKU launch.
3. **Stage 2 — month 4 of selling (Gate 2 passed):** add a cotton waffle duvet cover set and replacement fitted-sheet/pillowcase bundles (Study B's O5) to raise order value; list the same sheet SKUs in Canada.
4. **Stage 3 — month 9 (Gate 3 passed):** test UK-native-size cotton duvet cover sets (Study B's O3 and Study A's P4) and convert the hospitality track if a buyer has accepted samples and terms.

Where the studies converge on numbers (independent models):

Case	Study A	Study B	Read
US differentiated cotton set	$66.49 price; $19.84 pre-ad contribution; 29.8% break-even ACoS	$69.99 price; $17.15 pre-ad contribution; 25.8% break-even ACoS	Same order of magnitude; both need cost per order under ~$17–20
Canada cotton set	CAD 91.49; CAD 25.96; 28.4%	CAD 89.99; CAD 20.93; 24.5%	Converge
UK cotton duvet set	£38.99; £8.23; 21.1%	£49.99; £7.93; 16.7%	Both find UK Amazon margins thin after VAT
High-investment cases	Conservative scenario loses $26k in 12 months	All high cases lose contribution at assumed CPC/CVR	Scale capital only after Gate 2

Where they differ and how this report resolves it:

Topic	Study A	Study B	Consolidated position
Top priority	US pre-washed cotton percale (4.15/5)	UK hospitality/private-label white linen (70/100); US cotton percale 66/100	Study B's top five sit within 5 points and it states the order is not robust. US cotton percale leads on Amazon evidence; hospitality runs as a parallel B2B evidence track.
Investment readiness	Conditional go with gates	Not investment-ready	Approve Stage 0 now; Stage 1 money is released only at Gate 1
US duty	16.7% cotton / 21.4% viscose (6.7% / 11.4% MFN + 10% Section 301)	20% "stress input", explicitly not statutory	Use 16.7% as the planning rate and Study B's 20% as a stress case; broker confirmation required
Test capital	$72k / $130k / $200k	$8.9k / $55k / $195k (US, illustrative)	Different scopes (B's low is a pillowcase bundle). Stage 1 sized $55–130k by Gate 1 results
CPC/CVR	Internal: $1.79 CPC, 11.1% CVR account; new-brand $2.40 / 8%	GAP — not measured	Study A's internal benchmarks fill the gap; Study B's heatmap (Figure 9) shows the break-even frontier
Complaint evidence	Qualitative themes; refund rates by colour (ACTUAL)	122 coded review cards; fit/sizing mentioned in 40–55%	Both point to fit after washing and colour accuracy

Package contents and figure index

This document is the single consolidated report. Supporting files sit beside it in research/bedding-feasibility/ in the repository: the consolidated workbook (Study A model tabs plus all Study B tabs), both original workbooks, the charts folder and the data and evidence archives.

Figure	What it shows	Source study
1	US sales are falling while ad intensity climbs (monthly sales and TACoS, Jan 2025 – Oct 2026)	Study A
2	Market scope changes the addressable opportunity: broad home bedding (2024) vs derived bed linen (2025)	Study B
3	Cotton niches combine real demand with low review barriers (tracked-rival revenue and median reviews by US segment)	Study A
4	Pre-washed cotton and waffle duvets sit below the 500-review line at mid prices	Study A
5	Discovery-sample price distributions by marketplace (sheets, duvet covers, protectors)	Study B
6	Study B feasibility priority: close scores are not decision-grade rankings	Study B
7	Visible trust barriers (median displayed ratings) and top-three observed-brand concentration in duvet queries	Study B
8	11 of 15 US bedding lines advertise above break-even ACoS (Jan–Oct 2026)	Study A
9	US medium case: contribution per ad-acquired order across CPC and conversion assumptions	Study B
10	A $66.49 cotton set keeps $19.84 before advertising (29.8%)	Study A
11	Price moves contribution most, then factory cost (P1 sensitivity)	Study A
12	Base case turns contribution-positive in month 5; conservative never does	Study A
13	A realistic US test needs about $130k; $72k at the floor (Study A)	Study A
14	Study B illustrative launch cash by marketplace (not supplier quotations)	Study B

Study A also published the same scenario chart as an interactive chart in the Claude doc; Study B's six figures are reproduced here from its Evidence and Scenario Charts PDF.

Study A executive summary (internal-account view)

Start a cotton-only bedding brand on Amazon US with one pre-washed 100% cotton percale sheet set at $59.99–69.99, a capped test budget of about $130k, and hard stop gates at week 6 and month 4 of selling; add a cotton waffle duvet set and Canada only if the gates pass, and leave the UK for a later test.

- **What to sell:** pre-washed, pre-shrunk long-staple cotton percale (250–300 TC) 4-piece sets in Full, Queen and King, four colours, 12 SKUs. It scores 4.15 of 5 on a risk-adjusted matrix of 18 options, ahead of waffle duvet covers (3.70) and the same set in Canada (3.60).
- **Where:** the US first (about 12× Canada's search volume), Canada on the same SKUs in months 4–6, the UK only after month 9. The UK's 0% duty is outweighed by 20% VAT, low price points and a Pakistani incumbent (Utopia) at £6–20; its contribution is £8.23 per duvet set (21%).
- **Positioning:** mid-premium real cotton with a verified fit after five washes, OEKO-TEX and honest specs — above the $39.99 niche median, below $80 incumbents and $159 DTC brands.
- **Economics:** about $20.34 landed (assumed FOB $14.53 × 1.40 freight and duty), $19.84 contribution before ads (29.8% break-even ACoS), about $11.87 (18%) at a mature 12% TACoS.
- **Investment:** $72k / **$130k** / $200k to test; a further $200–350k to scale. Base case: $537k revenue, $129k ads and $29k contribution in 12 months, one-time costs recovered in month 12; the conservative case loses $26k and triggers the stop rule.
- **Why it is not a sure thing:** our established account is weakening (US sales −22.7% and net profit −48% year to date; TACoS up from 9.8% to 15.2%), our second brand pays a 5–9 point TACoS penalty, and our newest brand pays $41 per ad order. A new brand must win on a narrow niche and a provable product difference, not on our account's history.

Evidence base: 37 months of Sellerboard P&L (Oct 2023 – Oct 2026), Command Center PPC and economics for 18 bedding products (Jan–Oct 2026 primary window), 27 Data Dive niches, Keepa and Brand Analytics, our SLQS quilt audit, and external research on fees, duties and markets read on 26 Oct 2026. The largest open input is the mill's real cost sheet: every margin here moves $3.13 per unit for each 15% change in FOB.

Scope, research window and data inventory

The primary window is year to date 2026 (1 Jan – 26 Oct 2026, 299 days); 2023-10 to 2025-12 is used only for seasonality and trend context. Research date for every external figure is 26 Oct 2026. October 2026 is a partial month and the last 7 days of ad data are still settling (7-day attribution).

Evidence labels used throughout: ACTUAL = measured in our accounts · CALC = calculated from actuals · EST = third-party estimate (Data Dive, BSR model, research reports) · ASSUMPTION = provisional input awaiting factory or forwarder quotes.

Which account is the bedding business: the Sellerboard account "Ecotero" (seller AY8VX9XAPH676) holds the three bedding brands — Decolure, Sleephoria and CooLinens — on Amazon.com and Amazon.ca. There is no Amazon UK seller account; UK conclusions rest on external research only.

Data source	Marketplace	Coverage	Granularity	Metrics available	Quality	Limitations	Research use
Sellerboard P&L (Ecotero)	US, CA	Oct 2023 – 26 Oct 2026 (37 months)	Account-month, child ASIN, parent	Sales, units, orders, refunds, promos, SP/SB/SD spend, referral, FBA, storage, LTSF, COGS, gross/net profit, sessions, unit session %	Complete	COGS entered by period (unit cost; freight/duty partly missing on some SKUs); storage booked in charge month	Account history, product P&L, refund rates, YoY
Ecotero Command Center — PPC	US, CA	Daily from 2025; search terms from 29 Dec 2025	Account, product, syntax group, search term, placement	Impressions, clicks, CTR, CPC, spend, orders, sales, CVR, ACoS, TACoS, match type, ad type	Complete	7-day attribution; off-Amazon placement CVR withheld (too few orders)	Ad benchmarks, CAC, wasted spend, launch curves
Command Center — unit economics	US, CA	Snapshot 26 Oct 2026 (units = last 28–30 days)	SKU, size, product	Price, referral, FBA fee, landed cost (Finance tab COGS), refund rate, contribution, break-even ACoS	Mostly complete	A few SKUs carry obviously wrong COGS (flagged as outliers)	Factory-to-customer cost model
Command Center — aged inventory	US, CA	Age snapshot 23 Oct 2026	Product, SKU, age bracket	Aged units, projected monthly surcharge, 6-month exposure	Complete (projection)	Projections, not bills; CA FX rate stale	Overstock lessons, working-capital risk
Command Center — competitors + Keepa	US (CA unmapped)	Roster scrape 25 Oct 2026; Keepa 2025-07 → today	Rival ASIN	Price, reviews, rating, BSR, sales band, coupons/deals, listing assets,	Partial	Sales bands are estimates (~1.4× the "bought in past month" badge);	Competitor leaderboard, price/deal behaviour

Data source	Marketplace	Coverage	Granularity	Metrics available	Quality	Limitations	Research use
				monthly price/BSR history		no CA roster	
Brand Analytics SQP (via Command Center)	US, CA	Weekly from 5 Jan 2025	Query × week × our ASIN	Market search volume, impressions, clicks, cart adds, purchases, our share, median price	Sample	Covers only queries our ASINs appear on	Seasonality, demand trend, share of purchases
Data Dive niches	US (27 niches); 2 CA; 1 UK (knee pillow — not bedding)	Research dates Jun 2025 – Oct 2026	Keyword, competitor ASIN	Search volume, suggested bids, rival price/reviews/est. units & revenue, ranking juice	Partial	Competitor lists pulled for 10 of 27 niches; volumes are Data Dive estimates	Demand sizing, review barrier, CPC by segment
Google Drive — SLQS audit (28 Aug 2026)	US	Jul–Aug 2026	Product, SKU	Quilt-set P&L, landed cost vs unit cost, refunds by colour, deal results	Complete for its scope	Single product	New-brand failure case study
External research (fees, duties, market, reviews)	US, CA, UK	Read 26 Oct 2026	Market / regulation	Fee tables, tariff rates, market sizes, complaint themes	Partial	Official sites and Amazon pages were blocked; figures come from search extracts of cited pages	Fees, landed cost, compliance, UK view

Not available anywhere: factory cost sheets (FOB) for new constructions, freight and brokerage quotes, Amazon return-reason codes, review text (Amazon blocked automated access), any UK sales or advertising data, and a Canada competitor roster. These are listed as open inputs in the last section.

Study B evidence base [Study B]. 33 query pages (11 per marketplace) collected 26 Oct 2026; 1,627 query-ASIN observations and 1,568 distinct marketplace-ASIN pairs; 15 product detail captures; 122 review cards from ten Canadian and UK product pages (reviewer locations: Canada 40, UK 33, US 25, other 24). Anonymous US and UK pages kept an overseas delivery destination (“Deliver to Colombia”) despite locality selection, and Canada had no fixed postcode, so Study B’s prices and visible listings are discovery data, not domestic rankings or market shares. Study B fetched official pages (FTC, GOV.UK, CBSA, CPSC, sell.amazon.*) directly; those citations are in the Sources section.

Existing account, Jan–Oct 2026

The established bedding account is large but its profit is thinning: US+CA sales of $11.37M year to date earned $0.33M net profit (2.9% margin), down from $0.73M (5.4%) in the same period of 2025. One product family — Decolure bamboo sheets in the US — earns more than the whole account’s profit. (ACTUAL, Sellerboard; like-for-like 1 Jan – 26 Oct in both years.)

1 Jan – 26 Oct	US 2025	US 2026	Canada 2025	Canada 2026
Sales (USD)	$11.98M	$9.27M (−22.7%)	$1.59M	$2.11M (+33.2%)
Units	250,428	200,282	35,923	48,079
Average selling price	$47.83	$46.26	$44.15	$43.92

1 Jan – 26 Oct	US 2025	US 2026	Canada 2025	Canada 2026
Ad spend / TACoS	$1.18M / 9.8%	$1.40M / 15.2%	$0.13M / 8.4%	$0.31M / 14.8%
Amazon fees % of sales	33.5%	38.3%	38.6%	38.4%
Storage + aged-stock fees % of sales	3.5%	6.5%	6.5%	5.8%
Refund rate (units)	5.6%	6.3%	6.2%	7.5%
Units per session (conversion)	6.4%	5.3%	4.7%	4.5%
Net profit / margin	$0.83M / 6.9%	$0.43M / 4.7%	−$0.10M / −6.4%	−$0.10M / −4.6%

What moved: US sales fell from roughly $1.0–1.2M a month in Q1 to $0.69M in September, while ad spend stayed near $130–170k a month, so TACoS rose from 10% to 15%. Fees and storage took a further 7.8 points of sales. Canada grew 33%, but more than doubled its ad spend and still lost money. The decline is accelerating: US sales in the last 90 days are down 28% and net profit down 77% year on year, and aged-stock fees reached $261.5k year to date against $92.2k a year earlier.

Product families, Jan–Oct 2026 (ACTUAL, Sellerboard parent rows):

Brand · family · marketplace	Sales	ASP	COGS / unit	Amazon fees / unit	TACoS	Net margin	Refunds
Decolure bamboo viscose sheet sets · US	$4.28M	$77.9	$28.8	$21.8	12.7%	16.7%	7.2%
Decolure satin sheet sets · US	$1.80M	$31.0	$10.6	$13.7	16.9%	0.0%	5.4%
Sleephoria/ Sleep Sanctuary satin sets · US	$0.62M	$32.5	$10.2	$17.1	22.4%	−11.7%	6.1%
Sleephoria cooling sheet sets · US	$0.59M	$67.2	$27.0	$19.2	7.4%	19.5%	6.0%
Sleephoria/ Sleep Sanctuary bamboo sets · US	$0.47M	$66.3	$29.6	$22.2	21.9%	−5.0%	7.0%
Decolure satin fitted sheet · US	$0.44M	$19.8	$5.1	$10.3	16.0%	1.8%	5.7%
Sleephoria cooling fitted sheet · US	$0.33M	$32.1	$14.1	$12.9	10.0%	2.1%	5.4%
Sleephoria quilt set · US	$0.05M	$34.2	$11.6	$68.8	48.6%	−196.6%	13.2%
Decolure bamboo sheet sets · CA	$1.36M	$62.4	$28.6	$20.5	14.2%	0.7%	7.8%
Decolure satin sheet sets · CA	$0.55M	$29.8	$10.7	$14.2	19.9%	−10.1%	8.1%

Amazon fees per unit include storage and aged-stock surcharges. Canada figures are converted to USD by Sellerboard.

Advertising (ACTUAL, Command Center, 1 Jan – 26 Oct 2026): US spend $1.33M for $3.87M ad sales — ACoS 34.4%, CPC $1.79, conversion 11.1%, 82,697 ad orders, so about $16.10 of ad spend per ad order. Canada spend CAD 402k for CAD 1.54M — ACoS 26.1%,

CPC CAD 1.93, conversion 11.4%. Against the previous 299 days, conversion fell about a quarter in both markets while clicks rose about 65%.

Inventory (ACTUAL, aged-stock snapshot 23 Oct 2026): 16,907 units are over 180 days old across 22 products, costing a projected $15.9k a month in aged-stock surcharges and about $70k over the next six months. The worst positions are the wide colour ranges: Decolure satin 4-piece (3,921 aged units, 36 SKUs) and Sleephoria satin 4-piece (2,946 aged units, 70 SKUs).

The closest internal analogue to a new brand is Sleephoria, the account's second brand selling the same constructions. It runs 5–9 points higher TACoS than Decolure on the same products and loses money in satin and bamboo, despite sharing the factory, the team and the PPC playbook.

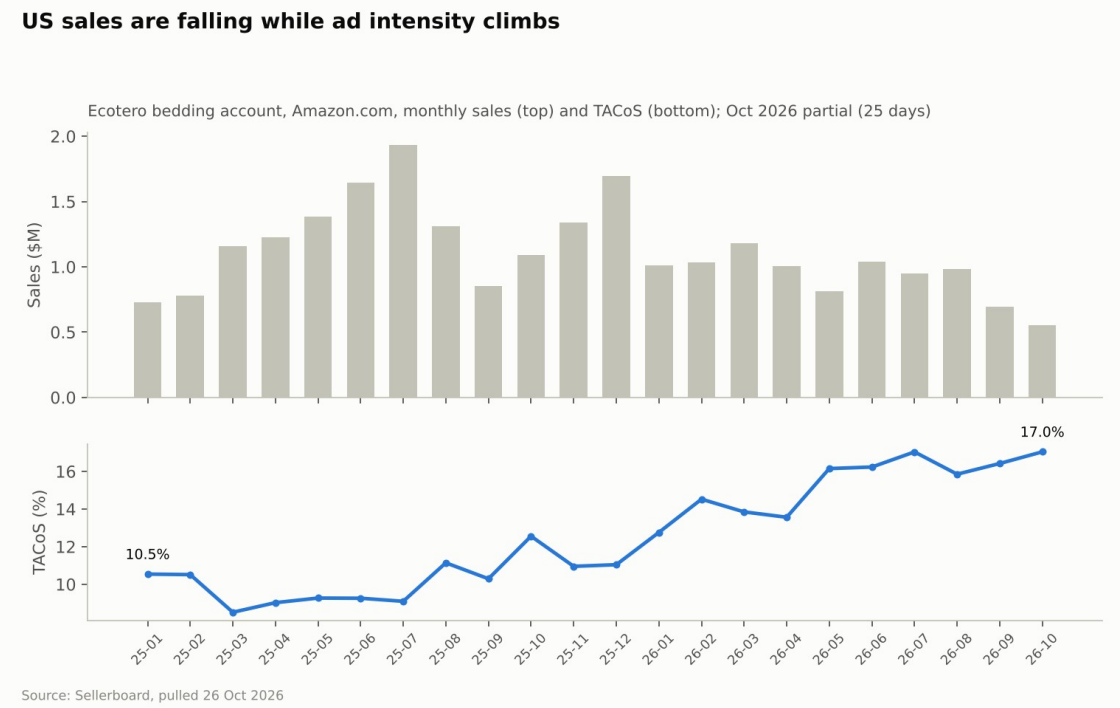


Figure 1. US sales are falling while ad intensity climbs (monthly sales and TACoS, Jan 2025 – Oct 2026)

Source: Study A · Sellerboard, pulled 26 Oct 2026.

Market size and product taxonomy

The US is roughly three times the UK and six times Canada in bed linen, but the market a new seller can actually reach on Amazon is far smaller than the headline: it is the handful of sub-segments where the top listings do not yet hold thousands of reviews. All sizes below are third-party estimates (EST).

Market	Bed linen market	Online share	Amazon-specific evidence
US	$8.6–10.9bn (2024–25)	28–34%	Amazon US bedding sales ~$3.1bn in 2024, including mattresses (Furniture Today); no source splits textiles
Canada	~$1.37bn (44% of a ~$3.1bn home-textile market, 2025)	~24%	No source found; our Canadian search volume is ~8% of US for

Market	Bed linen market	Online share	Amazon-specific evidence
			the same queries
UK	~$3.5bn (Mordor-implied; range $1.8–5.4bn by definition)	UK bedding e-commerce ~$1.26bn (2024)	Amazon is among the top 5 UK bedroom-textile retailers with Dunelm, ASDA, Tesco and B&M (low-quality source)

Three layers matter: the broad market above; the Amazon-addressable market, sized below from tracked competitor sets; and the realistic new-entrant slice, which depends on the review barrier and ad cost in each segment.

US segment taxonomy (Data Dive estimates at each niche's research date, Mar–Oct 2026 unless noted; CPC = median suggested bid of the top 50 keywords):

Segment	Head-term monthly searches	Median price	Median reviews of tracked rivals	Rivals under 500 reviews	Est. monthly revenue of tracked set	Suggested CPC	Seasonality	Fit for a Pakistan mill
Generic sheet & pillowcase sets (mostly microfiber)	"queen sheets" 205–291k	$35.98	26,544	0%	$79.6M (30 rivals)	$2.64	Q4 + January	Low: price war led by CGK, Utopia, Bedsure
100% / organic cotton sheet sets	"cotton sheets" 97k	$63.99	2,453	15%	$11.9M (20)	$2.63	Stable	High: core Pakistani construction
Pre-washed cotton sheet sets	niche head 25k	$39.99	492	73%	$4.5M (11, upper bound)	$2.21	Stable	High
Viscose-from-bamboo sheet sets	"bamboo sheets" 205–342k	$88.99	2,782	14%	$9.0M (21)	$6.43	Jun–Aug, Nov	Medium: viscose fabric often Chinese-woven (origin risk)
Cooling sheet sets	"cooling sheets" 112k	$69.99	1,934	10%	$8.4M (30)	$1.41	May–Aug at ~3× January	Medium
Polyester satin sheet sets	"silk sheets" 133k, "satin sheets" 78k	$25.49–26.99	1,074–5,500	0–27%	$3.5–6.1M	$1.25–1.97	Flat, November bump	Medium: low price, polyester
Fitted sheets (satin / bamboo)	108k / 695k niche total	$18.49 / $49.99	662 / 224	35% / 60%	$0.47M / $6.9M	$1.11 / n.a.	Follows parent	High
Linen sheets (Jun 2025 data)	"linen sheets" 58k	$129.89	1,004	30%	$1.3M (10)	$2.61	Summer	Low–medium: flax imported
Solid duvet covers	"duvet cover" 504k	$44.99	3,194	19%	$13.0M (26)	$1.29	Autumn–winter	High (cotton)
Waffle-weave duvet covers	"queen duvet cover" 132k	$56.99	131	85%	$2.8M (13); top 3 = 90%	$1.44	Autumn–winter	High: needs dobby/waffle looms
Quilt sets	"quilt" 182k	$29.99	1,609	20%	$3.8M (25)	$0.56	Spring–summer	Medium: bulky, 0.7 cu ft box
Comforters	—	$54	757	—	—	—	Q4	Medium: bulky
Waterproof mattress protectors (Aug 2025)	"twin xl mattress protector" 122k	$27.49	6,073	5%	$6.4M (20)	$1.86	Back-to-school	Medium: needs TPU-laminated fabric
Latex mattress	"latex mattress	$207	257	60%	$1.0M (5)	$1.33	—	Low: not a textile line;

Segment	Head-term monthly searches	Median price	Median reviews of tracked rivals	Rivals under 500 reviews	Est. monthly revenue of tracked set	Suggested CPC	Seasonality	Fit for a Pakistan mill
toppers	topper” 25k							oversize FBA fees
Silk / satin pillowcases	“silk pillowcase” 120k	$22 (all pillowcases)	3,135	—	—	$3.05	Nov–Dec	Low for mulberry silk; medium for satin

Revenue totals are upper bounds: Data Dive repeats parent-level sales on sibling ASINs. The UK and Canada have no equivalent niche data; their segment views are in the marketplace section.

Publisher estimates used by Study B [Study B, M01–M03, M07–M09]. Grand View Research broad home bedding 2024 (includes mattresses, pillows, blankets, toppers): US $32.75bn, Canada $6.06bn, UK $8.02bn; forecast CAGR 2025–33 of 8.8%, 10.9% and 7.2%; online share 24.8%, 21.9% and 32.5%. Mordor home textiles 2025: US $26.48bn, Canada $3.12bn, UK $7.62bn; multiplied by Mordor’s bed-linen shares this gives derived bed linen of $11.16bn, $1.37bn and $3.50bn. The two series have different scopes and years and should not be averaged; neither is Amazon demand. Dunelm FY2026 reported £1,825m revenue (+3.1%) and a 7.9% share of UK homewares and furniture, with 42% digital participation [DUNELM26].

Material distinctions both studies apply [Study B, D01, R02]. Percale and sateen are weaves of cotton, not fibres; “bamboo” is regenerated cellulose that must be labelled rayon or viscose made from bamboo; TENCEL is a trademark, not proof of lyocell content; linen-look cotton is not linen. Proposed test ranges: 200–300 single-ply TC percale, 300–500 single-ply TC sateen, 150–180 GSM linen. A live LANE LINEN page claims 160 TC/120 GSM organic percale while Brooklinen claims 270 TC percale and 480 TC sateen with a 12–16 inch best-fit range on a 16 inch pocket — thread count alone does not prove performance. US/Canadian Queen mattresses are 60 × 80 in and King 76 × 80 in; UK Double is 135 × 190 cm and King 150 × 200 cm, so sizes cannot be relabelled across markets.

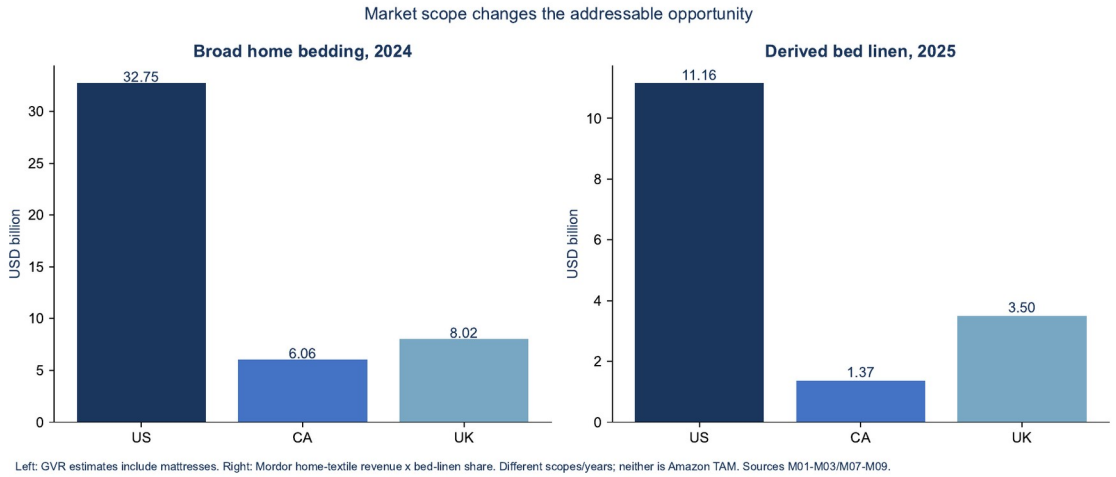


Figure 2. Market scope changes the addressable opportunity: broad home bedding (2024) vs derived bed linen (2025)

Source: Study B · Grand View Research and Mordor estimates (M01–M03, M07–M09); neither is Amazon TAM.

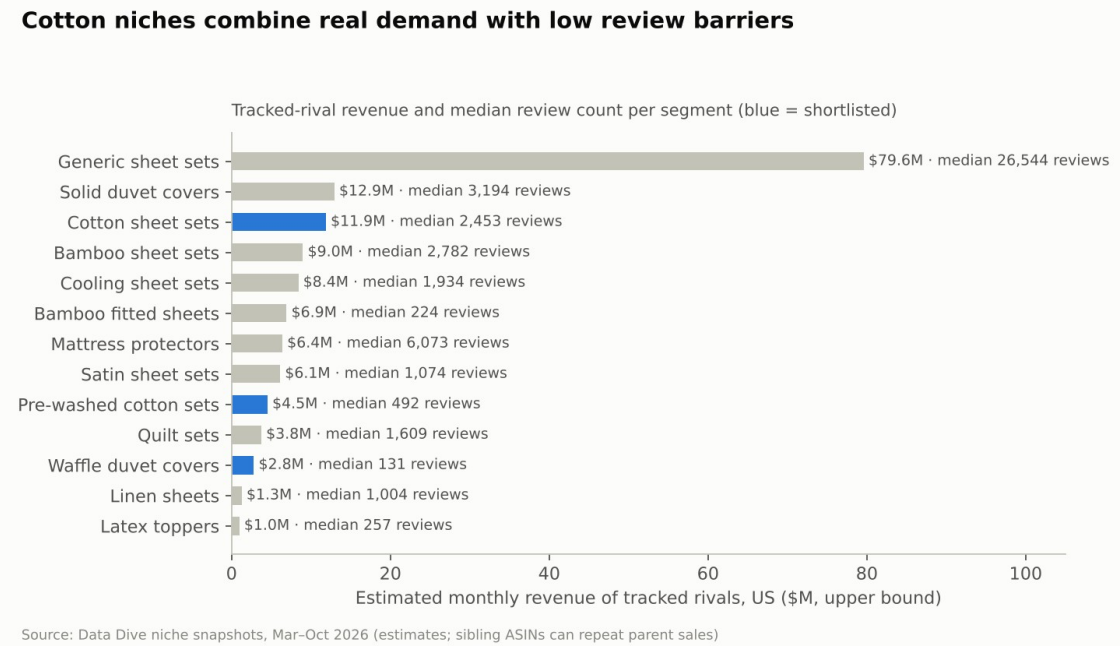


Figure 3. Cotton niches combine real demand with low review barriers (tracked-rival revenue and median reviews by US segment)

Source: Study A · Data Dive niche snapshots, Mar–Oct 2026 (estimates, upper bounds).

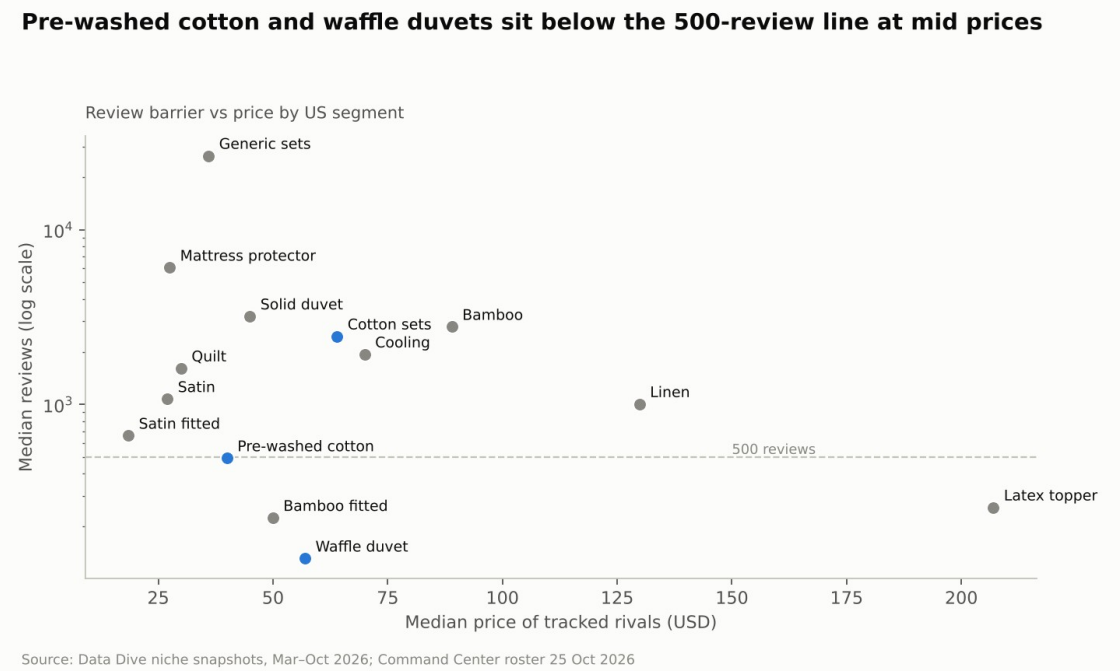


Figure 4. Pre-washed cotton and waffle duvets sit below the 500-review line at mid prices

Source: Study A · Data Dive niche snapshots; Command Center roster 25 Oct 2026.

Marketplace analysis: US, Canada, UK

Launch the US first, follow with Canada on the same SKUs within 4–6 months, and treat the UK as a later, selective test with UK-size products. The US has the demand and our operating know-how; Canada is cheap to add because sizes and labels largely carry over; the UK's 0% duty is outweighed by 20% VAT, low price points and a Pakistani incumbent (Utopia) that already dominates at £6–20.

	Amazon US	Amazon Canada	Amazon UK
Bed linen market (EST)	$8.6–10.9bn; 28–34% online	~$1.37bn; ~24% online	~$3.5bn (range $1.8–5.4bn)
Addressable demand signal	"cotton sheets" 97k + "100% cotton sheets" 71k monthly searches; tracked cotton set revenue ~$11.9M/month (EST)	~8% of US search volume for the same queries (SQP, ACTUAL); CA bamboo niche ~6.4k units/month across 20 rivals	No internal data; UK fitted-sheet and duvet-set best sellers carry 100k+ ratings
Leading segments	Generic microfiber sets, bamboo, cotton, duvet covers, satin, quilts	Bamboo and satin (our brands lead), generic sets	Fitted sheets, duvet cover sets, pillowcases, mattress protectors; 4-piece US-style sets are weaker
Price tiers	Low $13–30 microfiber/satin · mid $40–70 cotton/cooling · high $80–150 bamboo/linen	Low CAD 25–45 · mid CAD 60–95 · high CAD 100+ (bamboo median ~CAD 92)	Low £6–20 microfibre · mid £11–34 cotton · high £40+ (Egyptian cotton, linen)
Main competitors	Bedsure, Pure Bamboo, CGK, California Design Den, LANE LINEN, MooMee, Love's Cabin, BEDELITE, Utopia	Decolure (ours) #1–2 in bamboo and satin; Amazon Basics, CGK, Softan, hotel-style unbranded	Utopia Bedding, Bedsure, Amazon Basics, GC Gaveno, Catherine Lansfield, Dreamscene, Sleepdown
Promotion behaviour	Leaders use strike-through list prices, few coupons; Prime Day (23–26 Jun 2026), October event, BFCM	Same events; our CA ads run at lower ACoS (26%)	Duvet demand rises autumn–winter; deep low-price competition
CPC (ACTUAL / EST)	Account $1.79; cotton terms $2.21–2.64 suggested	Account CAD 1.93; CA suggested bids CAD 0.50–0.77	No internal data; third-party UK benchmarks not found
Review barrier	Cotton sets median 2,453; pre-washed niche 492	Bamboo 522, satin 1,406	Leaders 100k+; cotton tier lower but unmeasured
Duty on cotton set	16.7% (incl. 10% Section 301)	17%	0% (DCTS) + 20% import VAT, recoverable
P1-type contribution before ads	$19.84 (29.8%)	CAD 25.96 (28.4%)	£8.23 (21.1%) on a duvet set
Launch capital (test, one family)	$72k low · $130k base · $200k high	+$35–60k incremental using US stock and listings	$60–90k (new SKUs in UK sizes, VAT, EORI, UK responsible person)
Main risks	10% tariff and importer-of-record rules; high CPC; review barrier	Small market; CARM security; bilingual labels; long transit	VAT and UK-size SKUs; price war with a Pakistani incumbent; no internal data
Difficulty for a new brand	High overall; medium in pre-washed cotton and waffle duvets	Medium–low	High
Recommendation	**Launch first**	**Launch later (months 4–6), same SKUs**	**Test selectively later (months 9–12), only after US validation**

Why not Canada first? Canada's lower review barrier and our team's strong share there make it the easiest place to win a Best Seller badge, but at ~8% of US demand it cannot prove whether the brand scales. It is better used as a cheap second market once US listings, images and reviews exist (the creative, A+ content and listing work carry over; how much US review history shows on Amazon.ca should be checked on our own listings before relying on it).

Why not the UK first? The UK needs different SKUs (Double, King, Super King; duvet-led), a separate VAT and compliance set-up, and has no internal data. Its contribution per unit is the lowest of the three markets even with 0% duty.

Observed price ranges by query [Study B, LIVE_*]. Displayed prices before conditional coupons, mixed sizes and sets; discovery samples, not recommended prices.

Market	Sheets (n, median, range)	Duvet	Fitted	Pillowcase	Protector	Topper	Comforter	Quilt
US (USD)	38 · 41.99 · 15.00–149.99	41 · 55.99 · 14.99–89.99	46 · 19.99 · 8.99–79.99	58 · 19.99 · 8.99–65.99	46 · 32.49 · 11.99–119.00	44 · 69.99 · 13.99–349.00	48 · 36.99 · 21.98–309.00	57 · 69.99 · 15.29–169.99
Canada (CAD)	47 · 56.99 · 32.77–119.99	43 · 69.99 · 38.99–179.99	48 · 26.74 · 10.96–64.99	48 · 18.49 · 10.99–56.96	48 · 30.95 · 13.00–79.99	48 · 74.94 · 25.99–554.00	48 · 56.49 · 23.80–149.05	44 · 98.44 · 34.19–176.76
UK (GBP)	17 · 47.22 · 12.05–77.10	29 · 21.04 · 10.55–38.00	25 · 11.37 · 7.16–31.18	19 · 9.89 · 3.99–22.92	24 · 11.38 · 6.99–26.00	29 · 31.99 · 9.94–130.24	GAP	GAP

Channels beyond Amazon [Study B]. DTC websites suit differentiated storytelling and bundles but carry unknown paid CAC, 3PL and parcel costs. Walmart, Wayfair, Etsy and eBay are candidate channels, not verified sales pools. Retail and wholesale need buyer interest and quote-backed wholesale contribution. Hospitality and institutional supply (UK first) rewards repeat laundering performance and has no Amazon review moat but a long B2B cycle. Private-label and contract manufacture lowers the marketing burden but concentrates customer, credit and quality risk.

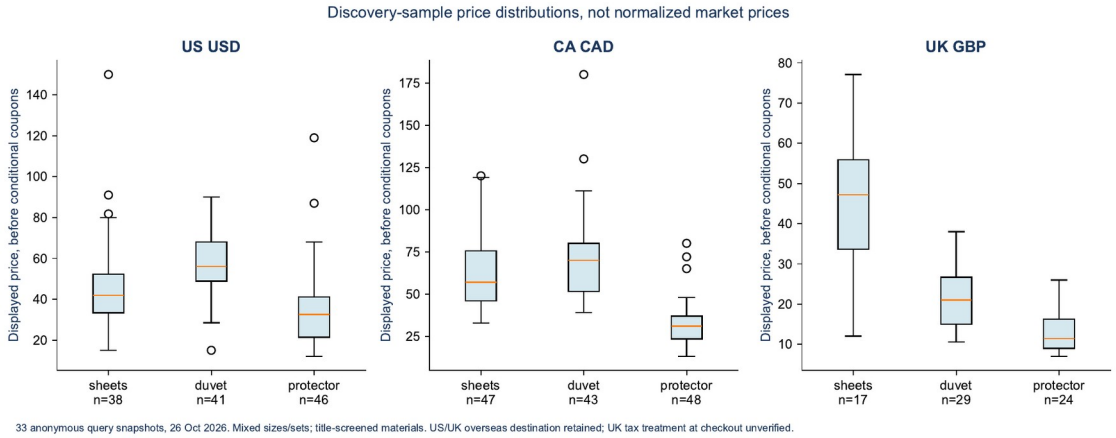


Figure 5. Discovery-sample price distributions by marketplace (sheets, duvet covers, protectors)

Source: Study B · 33 anonymous query snapshots, 26 Oct 2026; overseas destination retained on US/UK pages.

Product opportunity matrix

Pre-washed 100% cotton percale sheet sets score highest on a risk-adjusted basis (4.15 of 5), followed by cotton waffle duvet covers (3.70) and Canada as a second market for the same sheet set (3.60). Bamboo scores well on demand and margin but poorly on competition and risk; microfiber, toppers and satin score lowest.

Method. Each opportunity is scored 1–5 on six criteria (5 = best for us), weighted: demand 20% (searches, tracked revenue), profitability 20% (break-even ACoS), competition 20% (review barrier and concentration, 5 = easiest), differentiation 15% (fixable complaints, room to stand apart), operational feasibility 15% (mill fit, duty, packaging cube) and risk 10% (regulatory, cannibalisation, internal track record; 5 = lowest risk). Scores are judgements built from the evidence cited in each row; change a score and the total moves accordingly in the workbook.

Opportunity	Demand	Profit	Competition	Differentiation	Operations	Risk	Score	Key evidence
Pre-washed	4	4	4	4	5	4	**4.15**	492 median

Opportunity	Demand	Profit	Competition	Differentiation	Operations	Risk	Score	Key evidence
cotton percale set · US								reviews, 73% of rivals < 500; $39.99 median; 29.8% break-even ACoS; core Pakistani construction; 16.7% duty
Cotton waffle duvet cover set · US	4	3	4	4	4	3	**3.70**	“duvet cover” 504k searches; median 131 reviews but Bedsure holds 90%; 28.1% break-even
Cotton percale set · Canada	2	4	4	4	4	4	**3.60**	~8% of US demand; review barrier 522; 28.4% break-even; our team leads CA
Cotton sateen set · US	2	4	3	3	5	4	3.40	“sateen sheets” only 6k searches; wrinkle complaints
Cotton fitted sheet (standalone) · US	3	2	4	3	5	4	3.40	Lowest review barrier (fitted median 501) but $17–39 prices
Solid cotton duvet cover · US	5	3	2	2	5	3	3.35	Large demand; median 3,194 reviews; Bedsure $6.5M/month
Viscose-from-bamboo set · US	5	5	2	2	3	2	3.35	37% break-even on our account, but CPC $6.43, 2,782 median reviews, Chinese-fabric origin risk, cannibalises Decolure
Cooling sheet set · US	4	4	2	3	3	3	3.20	Seasonal 3× swing; 3,324 median reviews; new CooLinens brand pays $41/order
Organic (GOTS) cotton set · US	3	4	2	4	3	3	3.15	$63.99 median; 2,453 reviews; certification cost
Quilt set · US	4	2	3	3	3	2	2.90	Our SLQS

Opportunity	Demand	Profit	Competition	Differentiation	Operations	Risk	Score	Key evidence
								lost $20k/month; FBA $11.81; 16% refunds on light colours
Linen set · US	2	4	3	3	2	3	2.85	58k searches; flax not grown in Pakistan
Polyester satin set · US	4	2	2	2	4	3	2.80	$26 median; 4,704 reviews; our satin earns ~0% net
Cotton percale duvet set · UK	3	2	2	3	4	3	2.75	0% duty but £8.23 contribution (21%) after VAT
Silk pillowcase · US	4	4	2	2	1	3	2.75	Mulberry silk is not a Pakistani core fibre
Waterproof mattress protector · US	4	3	1	2	3	3	2.65	6,073 median reviews; Utopia 123k reviews
Comforter · US	3	3	3	2	2	2	2.60	Bulky FBA and storage; REST dominates premium
Microfiber generic set · US/UK	5	1	1	1	3	2	2.20	CGK 443k reviews at $25–35; Utopia £6–11 in the UK
Latex mattress topper · US	1	3	3	2	1	2	2.05	Not a textile line; oversize fees; flammability rules

The top opportunity against the 13 questions (P1, pre-washed cotton percale set, US):

1. **What are customers buying?** Breathable 100% cotton 4-piece sets at $40–70, mostly Queen and King.
2. **Why?** Cooler, crisper sleep than microfiber; “real cotton” without the price of DTC brands ($159+ at Brooklinen).
3. **Dominant specs:** 200–400 TC percale, long-staple or combed cotton, 15–16” pockets, garment-washed or stonewashed finish.
4. **Common complaints:** shrinkage that leaves pockets too shallow, pilling, wrinkles, scratchy first feel.
5. **Price points with demand:** $40–60 (LANE LINEN, MooMee, CDD) and $60–85 (MooMee, organic tier).
6. **What justifies a premium:** measured post-wash pocket depth, long-staple yarn, OEKO-TEX, pre-washed softness, honest thread count.
7. **What is commoditised:** “luxury hotel”, thread-count claims, colour count.
8. **Can a Pakistan mill make it competitively?** Yes: cotton percale is Pakistan’s core bed-linen export ($3.1bn bed-wear exports FY24-25), and in-house weaving secures origin.
9. **QC and testing:** dimensional stability after 3 and 5 washes (AATCC 135), pilling (ASTM D3512), colour-fastness to washing and light, seam strength, OEKO-TEX Standard 100.
10. **Landed cost and contribution:** $20.34 landed, $19.84 contribution before ads (29.8%).
11. **Launch advertising:** $20–45 per order early; $35k base for 90 days.
12. **Entry difficulty:** medium in the pre-washed sub-niche, high on generic “cotton sheets”.
13. **What would make it meaningfully different:** a published shrink-tested fit (for example “fits 16” after 5 washes”), corner labels, a mill-direct quality story, and fewer, better colours.

Study B scorecard [Study B]. Nine weighted dimensions (demand 15%, growth 5%, competition ease 15%, differentiation 15%, acquisition ease 10%, contribution potential 15%, manufacturing feasibility 10%, capital efficiency 10%, risk resilience 5%); scores are analyst judgements, and a one-point change in any 15% dimension moves the total 3 points.

ID	Opportunity	Score /100	Disposition	Confidence	Study A equivalent
O1	UK hospitality/private-label cotton-rich white linen	70	Investigate first	Medium-low	Not assessed (B2B, outside Amazon scope) — run as parallel evidence track
O5	US replacement pillowcase / fitted-sheet bundles	67	Investigate further	Low	Cotton fitted sheet standalone 3.40/5 — add as range extension
O2	US wash-tested cotton percale with verified mattress fit	66	Investigate first	Medium-low	Pre-washed cotton percale set 4.15/5 — launch track
O3	UK native-size easy-fit cotton duvet cover system	66	Investigate first	Medium-low	UK percale duvet set 2.75/5 — later test
O4	CA fit-validated cotton sheets with local replenishment	65	Investigate further	Low-medium	Canada percale set 3.60/5 — follow-on
O6	UK premium linen/lyocell DTC collection	53	Postpone	Low	Linen 2.85/5 — postpone
O7	US commodity microfiber sheet set	49	Avoid head-on entry	Medium	Microfiber 2.20/5 — avoid
O8	CA commodity waterproof mattress protector	43	Postpone	Medium-low	Protector 2.65/5 — postpone
O10	UK commodity comforter / duvet insert	43	Postpone	Low	Comforter 2.60/5 — postpone
O9	US bulky foam mattress topper	42	Postpone	Medium-low	Topper 2.05/5 — avoid

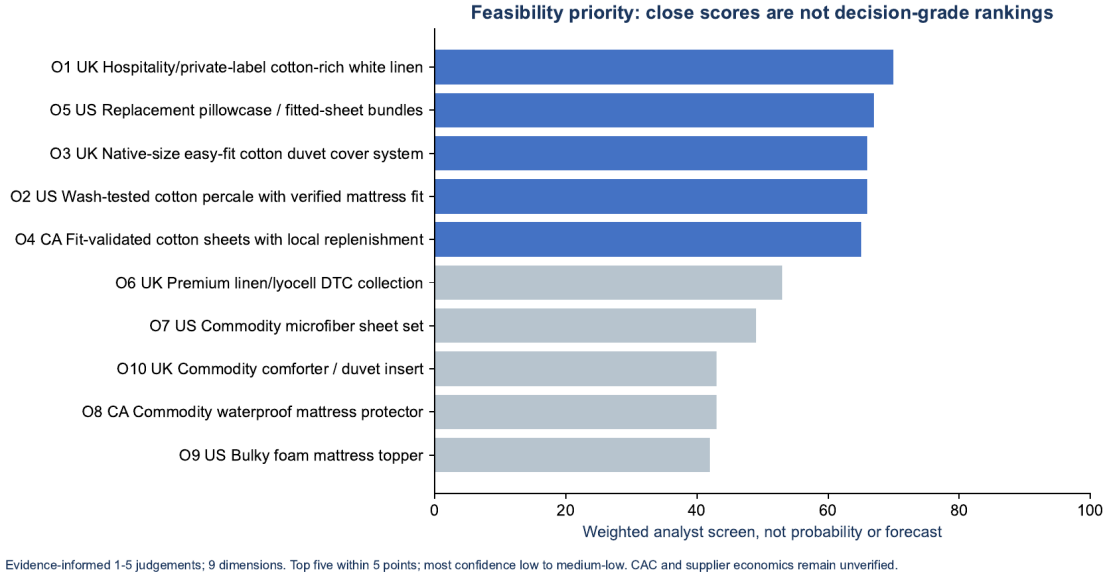


Figure 6. Study B feasibility priority: close scores are not decision-grade rankings

Source: Study B · weighted analyst screen, 9 dimensions.

Competitor leaderboard and how the leaders win

Each US segment is held by two or three brands with tens of thousands of reviews and 300–450 new reviews a month; the top 10 brands hold 79–98% of estimated units in every segment we track. Leaders win on review mass, wide size-and-colour grids and strike-through list prices, not on coupons. Rival units and revenue are estimates from sales-rank brackets (as of 25 Oct 2026), which run about 1.4× higher than Amazon's "bought in past month" badge.

US leaderboard by segment (EST unless marked):

Segment	Leader · price · reviews · est. units/month	#2	#3	Top-3 share of tracked units	Our share of tracked units
Viscose-from-bamboo sets	Bedsure · $56 · 65.2k · ~37k	Pure Bamboo · $100 · 23.6k · ~35k	Love's Cabin · $36 · 2.0k · ~20k	52%	1.1%
Polyester satin sets	BEDELITE · $36 · 6.8k · ~34k	Love's Cabin · $20 · 5.8k · ~14k	MR&HM · $32 · 17.9k · ~10k	52%	3.3%
Cooling sheet sets	Bedsure · ~37k	Pure Bamboo · ~35k	Bella Coterie · $135 · 5.9k · ~11k	63%	0.8%
Quilt sets	Love's Cabin · $27 · 9.5k · ~26k	WDCOZY · $45 · 6.0k · ~17k	Exclusivo Mezcla · $25 · 17.4k · ~5.6k	59%	0.03%
Comforters	REST · $172 · 4.1k · ~8.4k	Cozy Bliss · $60 · 2.7k · ~5k	HOMFINE · $44 · ~2.6k	69%	—
Pillowcases	ZIMASILK · $37 · 52k · ~26k	INFIIXSO · $65 · 10.6k · ~26k	WISHSMILE · $20 · ~7k	63%	—
Fitted sheets	BEDELITE · $18 · 1.9k · ~9.8k	Zaizaihome · $29 · 1.1k · ~4k	Homiest · $14 · ~3k	63%	—
Cotton sheet sets (Data Dive revenue)	LANE LINEN · $35–85 · 30.8k · $5.2M/mo	California Design Den · $28–90 · 87.1k · $4.2M/mo	MooMee · $80 · 1.7k · $0.7M/mo	54%	none
Pre-washed cotton sets (Data Dive)	LANE LINEN · $40–75 · 33.6k · $2.3M/mo	MooMee · $35–80 · 1.0k · $1.9M/mo	K MASANIJI · $60 · 495 · $0.16M/mo	85%	none
Solid duvet covers (Data Dive)	Bedsure · $18–175 · 38.5k · $6.5M/mo	MooMee · $90 · 14.9k · $2.1M/mo	CGK Unlimited · $38 · 8.5k · $1.1M/mo	46%	none
Waffle duvet covers (Data Dive)	Bedsure · $84–90 · 4.2k · $2.2M/mo	PHF · $38–40 · 1.0k · $0.37M/mo	David's Home · $47–55 · 193	90%	none
Waterproof mattress protectors (Data Dive)	Utopia Bedding · $25–29 · 123k · $2.8M/mo	Nordic Elk · $30 · 18.1k	Four Seasons Essentials · $39–42 · 13.1k	56%	none
Generic sheet sets (Data Dive)	CGK Unlimited · $25–35 · 443k · $19.4M/mo	California Design Den · $37–70 · 88k · $11.3M/mo	LANE LINEN · $45–90 · 32.9k · $11.2M/mo	36%	none

Review barrier, top-20 core rivals (median / p75 reviews): satin 4,704 / 6,994 · cooling 3,324 / 8,488 · pillowcases 3,135 / 7,255 · bamboo 1,961 / 5,940 · quilts 1,529 / 4,420 · comforters 757 / 1,493 · fitted sheets 501 / 680. Prices (p25 / median / p75): bamboo $60 / $80 / $100 · cooling $65 / $85 / $119 · quilts $28 / $39 / $45 · satin $20 / $26 / $29 · fitted $17 / $22 / $39.

How the leaders win (Keepa, Jan–Oct 2026, observed):

- **Review velocity, not coupons.** Pure Bamboo added ~448 reviews a month and Bedsure ~341; satin leaders MR&HM and BEDELITE added 184–195. Leaders ran coupons on almost no days this year.
- **Strike-through list prices.** Pure Bamboo sells at $105 against a $140 list price, Bedsure at $59 against $75, Lanest at $29 against $41.
- **Deep size-and-colour grids** that collect every size and colour search under one parent, plus A+ content and 7–9 images on all leaders.
- **Two price models coexist.** Volume brands (Bedsure, Love's Cabin, CGK) sit at $20–60; premium brands (Pure Bamboo, Bella Coterie, REST) sell at $100–350 on a single strong claim — genuine bamboo or cooling technology — with fewer reviews.

Who is behind them (research, not verified at source): Utopia Bedding is a Karachi mill brand that self-reports $169.5M exports in FY24 and leads Amazon UK; California Design Den and Mayfair Linen are made in India; Bedsure belongs to Shinebed (Wuxi, China). A Pakistani mill-owned brand winning on Amazon is therefore proven, but only at very large scale and low price.

Vulnerabilities a new entrant could use: pre-washed cotton and waffle duvet covers have leaders with fewer than 500 reviews below the top two; fitted sheets have the lowest review barrier; quilt and satin leaders draw complaints about thinness, colour and slipping that a mill can fix; and no tracked leader states a measured pocket depth after washing.

Canada: our own brands lead. Decolure ranks #1–2 in Canadian bamboo (~1.2–1.3k units/month each) and #1 in satin (~1.2k); Canadian rivals' median reviews are 522 in bamboo and 1,406 in satin (Data Dive, Jan–Feb 2026).

UK (Best Seller snapshots, undated): Utopia Bedding is #1 in fitted sheets (from £6.37, 135k ratings), sheet sets, duvet sets and pillowcases; Bedsure, Amazon Basics, GC Gaveno, Sonia Moonlight and Pamposh fill the microfibre tier; Catherine Lansfield, Dreamscene and Sleepdown lead printed duvet sets at £8–25; cotton sits at £11–34 (Yard, Amazon Basics 400TC).

Observed comparators by market [Study B, LIVE_*; PDP*_]. Strong observed comparators, not a measured sales leadership ranking.

Country / segment	Comparators observed	Why difficult / plausible gap
US value sheets / fitted	CGK, Utopia, Amazon Basics	Huge visible rating pools at low prices; compete on a verified fit need, not generic softness
US cotton sheets	LANE LINEN, California Design Den, THREAD SPREAD	Organic, percale and 400 TC sateen already available; fit and durability must be meaningfully better
US duvet / quilts / comforters	Bedsure, JELLYMONI, MooMee	Broad colour and configuration choice; style alone creates inventory risk
US protectors / toppers	SafeRest, PlushDeluxe, Utopia, EASELAND	Ratings, membrane performance and fulfilment efficiency
Canada sheets / duvet	California Design Den, LANE LINEN, THREAD SPREAD, LIFETOWN, JELLYMONI, Bedsure	Established imported assortments plus domestic retail anchors
Canada protector / topper	Utopia, Sasttie, BEDLORE, Niagara Sleep Solution	Low price anchors; membrane/loft claims need validation
UK sheets / duvet	Utopia, Sapphire Collection, Yard, GC GAVENO CAVAILIA	Native sizes, value offers and local style language
UK protectors / toppers	Silentnight, GMTEXTILES	Recognised names; bulky economics
Retail / DTC	Brooklinen (US); IKEA (CA, Queen fitted CAD 17.99–34.99); Dunelm, IKEA (UK)	Retail value anchors and brand trust

Concrete listing examples: CGK-linked B01M16WBW1 shows about 464.6k ratings at $24.99; California Design Den B06XS1P6NG about 47.8k at $52.99; LANE LINEN B07RY59C3W about 35.2k at $44.99; SafeRest B003PWNH4Q about 280.6k. Buy-box sellers observed include LANE LINEN sold by Homespun Global and Bedsure by Bedsure Collections. In Study B's Canadian bamboo query, DECOLURE (our brand) appeared among the three most visible brands with Bambaw and Hotel Sheets Direct. Gul Ahmed and Nishat Mills (Pakistan) and Welspun (India) are relevant integrated home-textile manufacturers to benchmark; none is an assumed supplier [C11–C14].

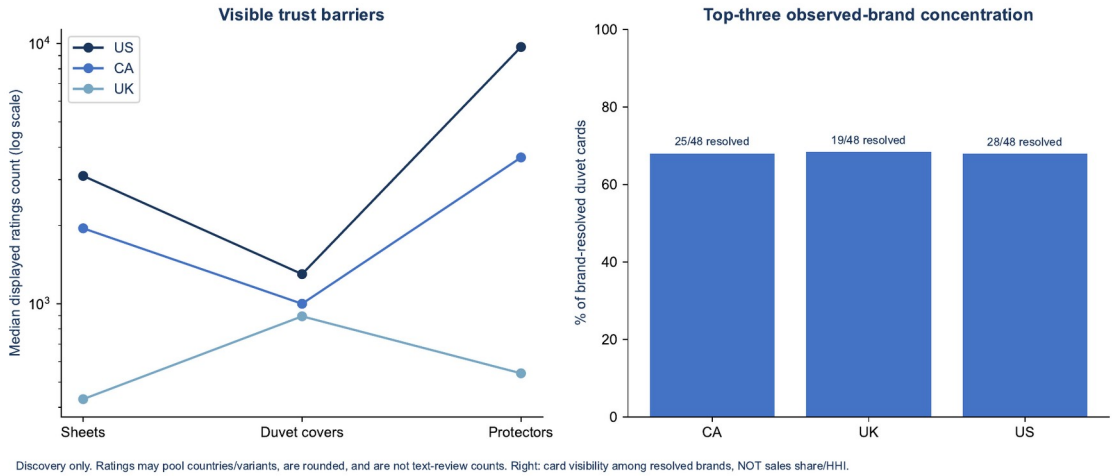


Figure 7. Visible trust barriers (median displayed ratings) and top-three observed-brand concentration in duvet queries

Source: Study B · screened query samples; card visibility, not sales share.

Entry difficulty and the three entry scenarios

A commodity entry would fail on our own evidence; the realistic path is a differentiated product placed inside a focused niche — Scenario B delivered through Scenario C. No ranking timeline is promised: our bamboo fitted-sheet launch held 45–67 orders a week only while spend stayed near $500 a week.

Difficulty indicators for the shortlisted US segments (EST unless marked):

Indicator	Pre-washed cotton sets	Generic “cotton sheets”	Waffle duvet covers	Bamboo (reference)
Head-term monthly searches	~25k niche head; long tail via size/colour terms	97k + 71k	132k (“queen duvet cover”)	205–342k
Median / p75 reviews of tracked rivals	492 / 724	2,453 / 9,596	131 / 276	2,782 / 5,938
Rivals under 500 reviews	73%	15%	85%	14%
Top-3 revenue share	85%	54%	90%	76%
Median price	$39.99	$63.99	$56.99	$88.99
Suggested CPC	$2.21	$2.63	$1.44	$6.43
Our internal proof	none	none	none	37% break-even, 16.7% net margin on Decolure

High top-3 shares in the two easiest niches mean one or two brands (LANE LINEN, MooMee; Bedsure) take most sales, but the long tail below them is thinly reviewed — the place a new brand can rank first.

	A — Commodity entry	B — Differentiated entry	C — Focused niche entry
Example	Microfiber or polyester satin sets at $20–35	Cotton percale set with tested fit, pre-washed finish, OEKO-TEX, honest specs	Pre-washed cotton percale sets and cotton waffle duvet covers
What makes entry hard	Leaders with 18k–443k reviews; satin median price $26; CPC above break-even	Proving the difference in images and reviews; head terms cost $2.6+ per click	Small head terms; one or two dominant brands; limited keyword pool
Structural barriers	Price floor set by Chinese microfiber ($3.90–7.50 FOB) and Utopia’s scale; our satin earns	Review mass of incumbents; 16.7% US duty	Niche ceiling; seasonality of duvets

	A — Commodity entry	B — Differentiated entry	C — Focused niche entry
	~0% net		
Temporary barriers	None that money removes cheaply	Zero reviews at launch; no brand recognition (Amazon drops unrecognised brand names from titles, as it did for Sleephoria)	Zero reviews; listing quality
What we must do	— (do not pursue)	Lab-test fit and shrinkage; show results on the listing; Vine; 4–6 colours only	Win the long-tail and size terms first, then widen to generic cotton terms
Early sign of success (weeks 4–12)	—	Conversion ≥ 8% on 1,500+ clicks; refund rate ≤ 7%; rating ≥ 4.3	Organic share ≥ 25% by week 12; top-10 rank on 3+ niche terms
Evidence to scale	—	Ad spend per order ≤ $25 and contribution after ads > 0 by month 4	Organic share ≥ 35% and TACoS ≤ 22% by month 6
Evidence to stop	Already met on internal data	Conversion < 6% after 3,000 clicks, or refunds > 10%	No organic traction (< 15% organic) by month 5 at full budget

Barriers that are structural for any newcomer: review counts in the thousands, the 10% US tariff on Pakistan (while it stands) and Amazon's inbound limits for new accounts. **Barriers that time removes:** zero reviews, unrecognised brand name and an empty search-term history — each costs money for 3–6 months, which the ad budget is sized for.

Advertising requirements and customer acquisition cost

A new brand should plan on $25–45 of ad spend per order in the first 90 days, versus $16 for our mature US account, and a 90-day US validation budget of about $30–45k for one product family. Internal figures are ACTUAL for 1 Jan – 26 Oct 2026 (Command Center, 7-day attribution); new-brand figures are CALC from the closest internal launches.

Internal benchmarks, US unless marked (ACTUAL, YTD 2026):

Product (maturity)	Spend	ACoS	CPC	Click-to-order CVR	Ad spend per order
Account average, US	$1.33M	34.4%	$1.79	11.1%	$16.11
Account average, Canada (CAD)	402k	26.1%	1.93	11.4%	16.95
Decolure bamboo 4-pc (mature, $89)	$282k	33.8%	$3.10	11.9%	$26.13
Decolure bamboo 6-pc (mature, $96)	$251k	29.4%	$3.39	14.1%	$23.97
Decolure satin 4-pc (mature, $32)	$184k	34.2%	$1.36	12.9%	$10.61
Sleephoria satin 4-pc (second brand)	$139k	42.6%	$2.05	14.5%	$14.18
Sleephoria bamboo 6-pc (second brand)	$103k	38.5%	$3.43	12.7%	$26.95
Sleephoria cooling sheets ($79)	$40k	26.4%	$2.09	11.9%	$17.61
Sleephoria quilt set (new brand-line, $42)	$23k	65.1%	$0.72	3.0%	$24.41
Decolure bamboo fitted (launched Jul 2026)	$3.8k	27.8%	$2.11	20.9%	$10.09
CooLinens cooling sheets (new brand, Oct 2026, $88)	$4.7k	47.4%	$3.38	8.2%	$41.32
Canada, Decolure bamboo 6-pc (CAD)	142k	23.4%	2.49	12.0%	20.77

By match type (US, drillable products): Exact $533k at $2.72 CPC, 42.4% ACoS, $20.02 per order; Broad $109k at $1.55 CPC, 23.9% ACoS, $12.09 per order; Phrase $17k at $0.94 CPC, 39.3% ACoS. **By objective (US):** Ranking campaigns ran at 43.2% ACoS on 33% of spend; defensive brand campaigns at 14.0%. The SLQS audit found the same pattern on quilts: top-of-search premiums cost 65% more per order than rest-of-search.

Market CPC by segment (EST, Data Dive median suggested bid of the top 50 keywords): bamboo $6.43 · cotton/generic sheet sets $2.21–2.64 · linen $2.61 · silk pillowcase $2.17 · satin $1.25–1.97 · mattress protector $1.86 · duvet covers $1.10–1.44 · cooling $1.41 · quilts $0.56. Third-party US Home & Kitchen benchmarks (Pacvue and others, 2025–26) are $0.80–1.35 CPC and 15–27% ACoS; our account pays more, so internal figures are used.

What the launches show:

- The new CooLinens brand pays $41 per order at 8.2% conversion — about 2.3× the mature Sleephoria cooling line ($17.61) on the same construction. Its sample is three weeks old.
- Decolure's bamboo fitted sheet sold 45–67 orders a week at ~$500 weekly spend in July, then fell to 4–7 orders a week once spend was cut to ~$70. Paid launches did not leave an organic base.
- Sleephoria's second-brand lines run 5–9 points higher ACoS than Decolure on identical products. That gap is the measured "no brand history" penalty.

New-entrant cost per order (CALC): cost per order = CPC ÷ conversion rate. For a cotton sheet set at about $60:

Scenario	CPC	Conversion	Ad spend per order	Spend for 10 / 100 / 1,000 orders
Low (good listing, long-tail and broad terms)	$1.80	9%	$20	$200 / $2,000 / $20,000
Base (internal second-brand experience)	$2.40	8%	$30	$300 / $3,000 / $30,000
High (CooLinens-type start, head terms)	$3.00	7%	$43	$430 / $4,300 / $43,000

At a $60 price these are 33%, 50% and 72% ACoS — above the ~30–35% break-even in the economics section. Launch advertising therefore loses money per order by design for the first 8–12 weeks; the budget is an investment in reviews and ranking, not profitable spend.

Recommended launch ad budget per product family, first 90 days (US): low $20k, base $35k, high $45k, run as broad/phrase discovery plus exact on long-tail and size terms, with no blanket top-of-search premium. Spend should be judged weekly on conversion and organic share, and cut if conversion is under 6% after 1,500 clicks.

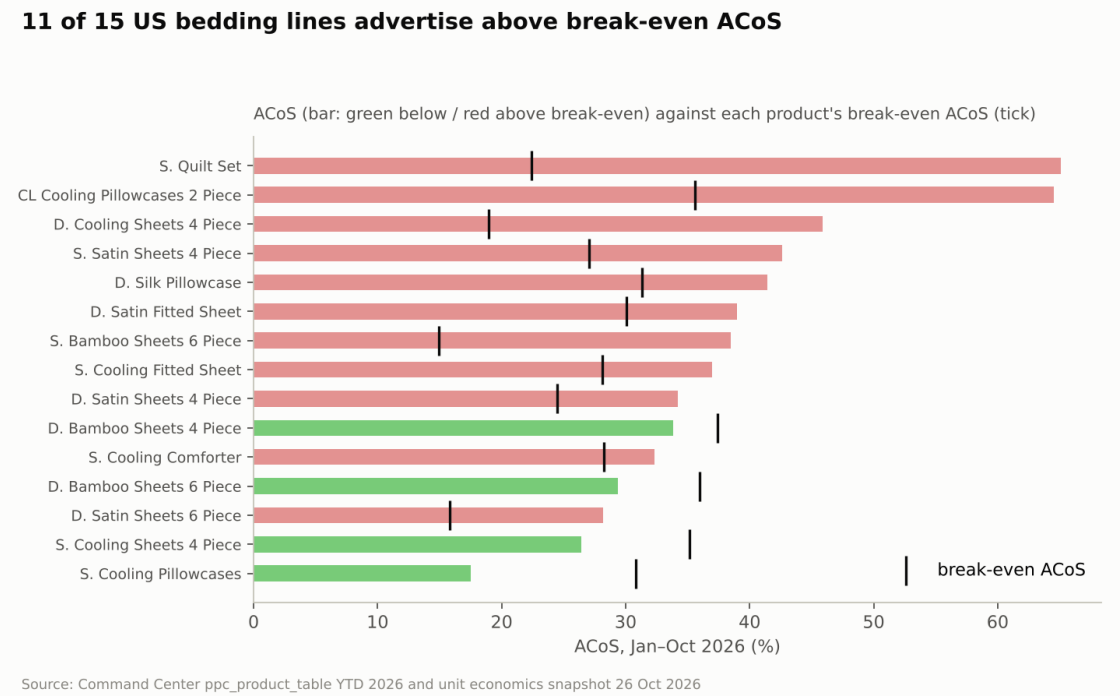


Figure 8. 11 of 15 US bedding lines advertise above break-even ACoS (Jan–Oct 2026)

Source: Study A · Command Center ppc_product_table YTD 2026 and unit economics 26 Oct 2026.

Why CPC cannot be judged without conversion [Study B]. Study B's US medium case (pre-ad contribution $17.15) shows contribution per ad-acquired order turning negative at $1.50 CPC with 8% conversion, or $1.00 CPC with 5% conversion. Study A's internal benchmarks place a new brand near $2.40 CPC and 8% conversion, which is why the launch phase is budgeted as an investment rather than profitable spend.

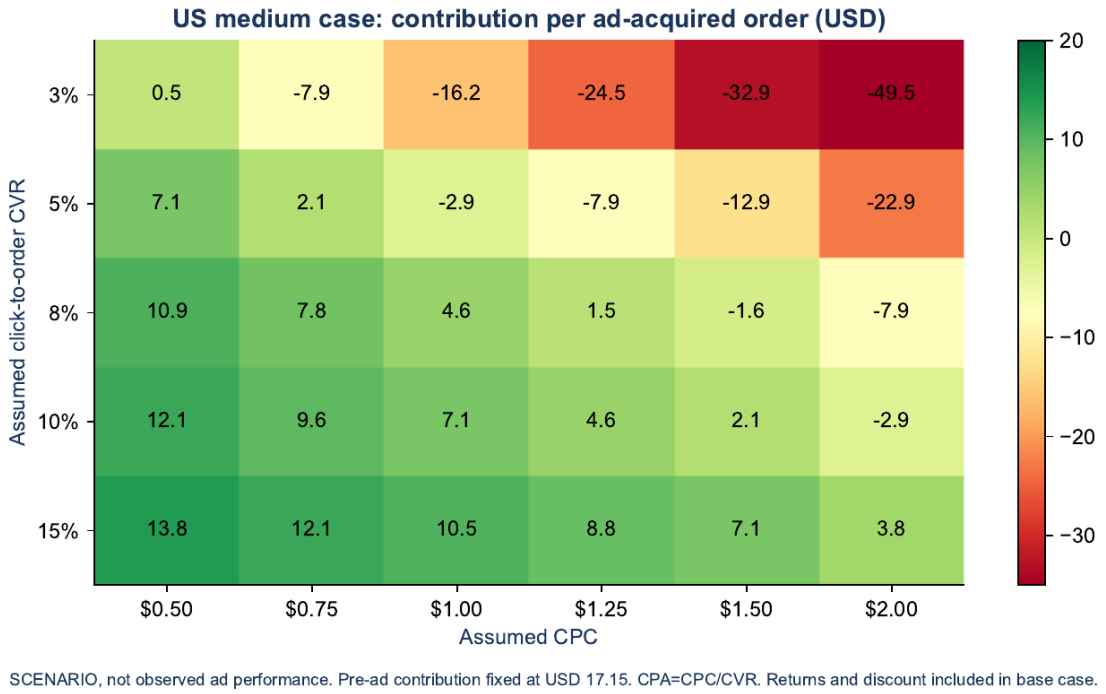


Figure 9. US medium case: contribution per ad-acquired order across CPC and conversion assumptions

Source: Study B · scenario, not observed ad performance; pre-ad contribution fixed at $17.15.

Unit economics, factory to customer

A pre-washed cotton percale set at about $66 earns $19.84 per unit before advertising in the US — a 30% break-even ACoS — and $11.87 (18%) at a mature 12% TACoS. That is close to the account's own bamboo engine in margin terms. The UK duvet set earns only £8.23 (21%) because of 20% VAT and low UK price points, despite 0% duty.

Basis: factory FOB prices are ASSUMPTIONS anchored to one vendor price guide for Karachi (200TC percale set $10.50–13.20, 250TC combed percale $12.40–14.80, 300TC sateen $14.20–17.40 FOB) and must be replaced by the mill's cost sheets. Fees, refund rates and landed-cost uplift come from our account (ACTUAL) and the research files (EST). FX: USD/CAD 1.3993, GBP/USD 1.3367 (23–26 Oct 2026).

Per unit, blended size mix	P1 US cotton percale set	P2 US waffle duvet set	P3 Canada percale set (CAD)	P4 UK percale duvet set (GBP)
Selling price (VAT-inclusive in UK)	66.49	77.49	91.49	38.99
− VAT	—	—	—	6.50
− Refunds	4.32 (6.5%)	5.04 (6.5%)	6.86 (7.5%)	1.62 (5%)
= Net revenue	62.17	72.45	84.63	30.87
Factory FOB	14.53	18.50	20.32	8.75
+ Freight, duty, brokerage	5.81 (×1.40)	7.40 (×1.40)	7.72 (×1.38)	1.58 (×1.18)
= Landed cost	20.34	25.90	28.05	10.33
Referral fee (15%)	9.33	10.87	12.69	5.56
FBA fulfilment	9.14	9.65	12.94	4.58
Storage + inbound	1.00	1.25	1.40	0.80

Per unit, blended size mix	P1 US cotton percale set	P2 US waffle duvet set	P3 Canada percale set (CAD)	P4 UK percale duvet set (GBP)
placement				
Unsellable returns (40% of refunds)	0.53	0.67	0.84	0.21
Promotions allowance (3%)	1.99	2.32	2.74	1.17
Contribution before ads	**19.84**	**21.79**	**25.96**	**8.23**
Contribution margin = break-even ACoS	29.8%	28.1%	28.4%	21.1%
Break-even ROAS	3.35	3.56	3.52	4.74
Target ACoS for 10% / 15% margin	19.8% / 14.8%	18.1% / 13.1%	18.4% / 13.4%	11.1% / 6.1%
Launch ad spend per order (CPC ÷ CVR)	30.00	22.86	21.44	12.50
Contribution after launch-phase ads	−10.16	−1.07	+4.52	−4.27
Contribution at 12% TACoS (mature)	11.87	12.49	14.98	3.55

Size-level prices and FOB (ASSUMPTION): P1 Full $59.99 / Queen $64.99 / King $69.99 on FOB $13.00 / $14.00 / $15.50; P2 Queen $74.99 / King $79.99 on FOB $17.50 / $19.50; P3 CAD 84.99 / 89.99 / 94.99; P4 £34.99 / 39.99 / 44.99 (Double / King / Super King) on FOB $10.50 / 12.00 / 13.50.

Internal comparators (ACTUAL, Command Center snapshot 26 Oct 2026): Decolure bamboo 4-pc US sells at $88.60 on a $28.47 landed cost and earns $33.12 (37.4% break-even ACoS). Decolure satin 4-pc US sells at $31.50 on $10.52 and earns $7.71 (24.5%). Sleephoria quilt set earns $9.48 (22.4%) at $42.33 because FBA alone costs $11.81. Cotton percale sits between bamboo and satin: a lower price than bamboo, but a duty saving of 4.7 points and a cheaper fabric.

Sensitivity of P1 contribution before ads ($19.84 base):

Variable	Low case → contribution	High case → contribution	Swing
Selling price ±10%	$14.76	$24.93	$10.17
Factory FOB +15% / −15%	$16.71	$22.97	$6.26
Refund rate 10% / 4%	$17.58	$21.46	$3.88
Freight + duty ×1.50 / ×1.31 (Section 301 struck down)	$18.35	$21.19	$2.83

Price matters most, then factory cost. Advertising matters more than any of them in the launch phase: each $0.40 change in CPC at 8% conversion moves cost per order by $5.

Units to recover launch investment: at the base one-time launch cost of $27,000 and the $35,000 90-day ad budget, P1 needs about 3,100 units at $19.84 to repay both, or about 5,200 units at the mature $11.87 after ads.

Cannot be calculated reliably yet: actual FOB and fabric consumption per size; freight and brokerage quotes; the real FBA fee from measured, weighed packages (dimensional weight drives the fee); whether the 10% Section 301 tariff survives; the importer-of-record structure; whether UK bedding falls in the 8% “Home Products” referral band under £20; and Canadian FBA fee tables.

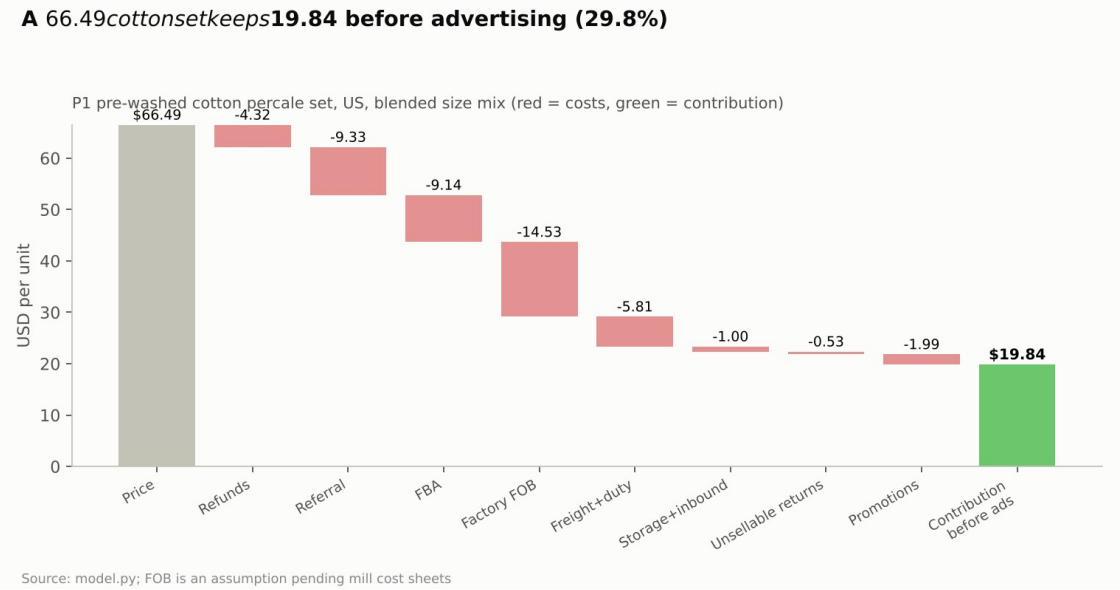


Figure 10. A $66.49 cotton set keeps $19.84 before advertising (29.8%)

Source: Study A · model.py; FOB is an assumption pending mill cost sheets.

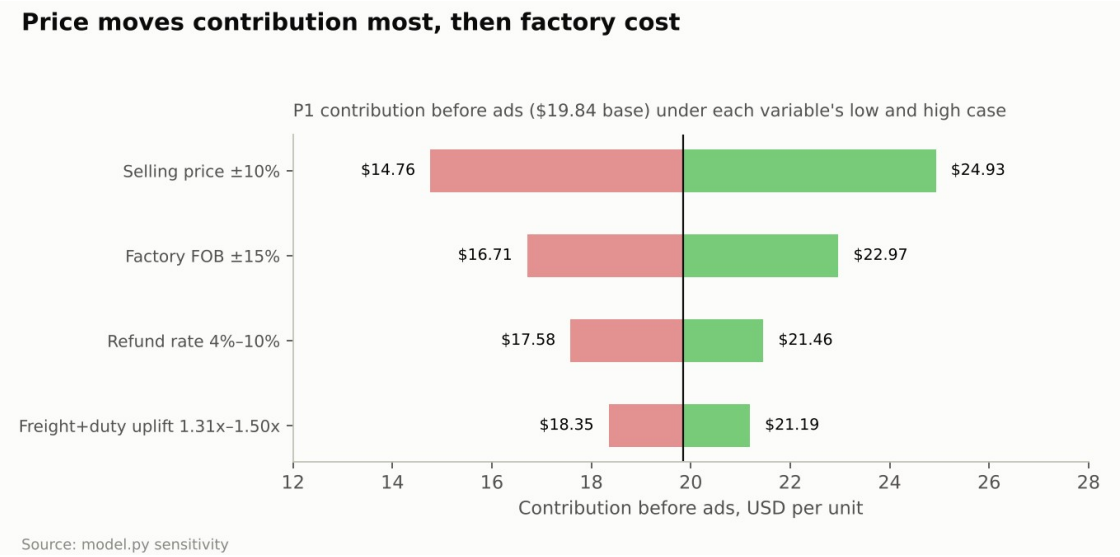


Figure 11. Price moves contribution most, then factory cost (P1 sensitivity)

Source: Study A · model.py.

Study B's nine illustrative cases [Study B, economics workbook]. Factory inputs are budget placeholders; US duty input 20% (stress, not statutory); UK 20% VAT and 8% referral at or below £20 under 2026 guidance; 5% discount; zero resale of returns.

Case	Price	Pre-ad CM	Blended CM	Break-even ACoS	Monthly break-even units	Launch cash
US-Low (USD)	29.99	7.90	2.28	27.7%	220	8,922
US-Medium (USD)	69.99	17.15	8.48	25.8%	177	54,954
US-High (USD)	79.99	13.40	−10.60	17.6%	none	195,041
CA-Low (CAD)	39.99	10.78	4.03	28.4%	124	10,285

Case	Price	Pre-ad CM	Blended CM	Break-even ACoS	Monthly break-even units	Launch cash
CA-Medium (CAD)	89.99	20.93	10.82	24.5%	139	67,749
CA-High (CAD)	109.99	20.62	−6.05	19.7%	none	246,011
UK-Low (GBP)	19.99	3.87	−0.26	20.4%	none	7,903
UK-Medium (GBP)	49.99	7.93	2.15	16.7%	698	43,355
UK-High (GBP)	64.99	6.98	−9.02	11.3%	none	158,737

Blended CM assumes 60% / 65% / 80% of orders are paid in the low / medium / high cases. The US-Medium case ($69.99, $17.15) is the closest equivalent to Study A's P1 ($66.49, $19.84).

Pakistan manufacturing, logistics, duties and compliance

The UK is the cheapest market to land Pakistani bed linen: 0% duty under the UK's developing-country scheme versus 16.7% (cotton) to 21.4% (viscose/polyester) in the US and 17% in Canada. The US is the largest market but carries a 10% Pakistan-specific tariff that is under court challenge. All rates below were read on 26 Oct 2026 from search extracts of the cited pages — official sites were blocked — so confirm each with a licensed broker before the first shipment.

Duty burden as a share of customs value (EST, see sources):

Product (HS line)	US	Canada	UK
Solid or printed cotton sheet set / duvet cover, no trim (6302.31.90 / 6302.21.90)	6.7% MFN + 10% Section 301 = 16.7%, plus 0.3464% MPF and 0.125% HMF	17% (GPT does not cover chapter 63)	12% MFN → 0% DCTS Enhanced (origin rules apply)
Cotton set with embroidery, piping or lace (6302.31.50)	20.9% + 10% = 30.9%	17%	0%
Cotton flannel (6302.31.70)	3.8% + 10% = 13.8%	17%	0%
Viscose "from bamboo" or polyester microfiber set (6302.32.20)	11.4% + 10% = 21.4%	17% (not individually confirmed)	0%
Linen / flax (6302.39.00)	4.3% + 10% = 14.3% (sources conflict)	not confirmed	0%
Polyester-shell comforter or quilt (9404.40.90)	12.8% + 10% = 22.8%	14%	0% (not confirmed)
Padded mattress protector (9404.90.96)	7.3% + 10% = 17.3%	not confirmed	not confirmed

If the Court of International Trade strikes down the Section 301 tariff (argued 30 Sep 2026, no ruling yet), US duty falls to about 7% for cotton and 11.9% for viscose or polyester. Keep entries open for refunds.

Design rules that follow from the tariff schedule:

- Use plain hems, not embroidery or piping: trim more than triples the US cotton rate (6.7% → 20.9%).
- Weave in-house. US and UK origin for bed linen follows the country where the fabric is woven; Chinese fabric sewn in Pakistan becomes Chinese goods and can lose the UK 0%.
- Cotton beats viscose and polyester on US duty by 4.7 points, which partly offsets cotton's higher fabric cost.

Landed cost uplift (ACTUAL proxy): the account's SLQS audit measured freight and duty adding 40–44% on top of factory unit cost for quilt sets in the US. Until forwarder quotes arrive,

this study uses FOB × 1.40 for US cotton, × 1.45 for US viscose/polyester, × 1.38 for Canada and × 1.18 for the UK (freight and clearance only). ASSUMPTION.

Operating models compared:

Model	How it works	Pros	Cons	Fit
Factory → Amazon FBA direct (FCL/LCL)	Karachi to destination port, broker clears, carrier delivers to FBA	Lowest handling cost; fastest to shelf	Amazon caps inbound quantities for new sellers; long-term storage risk; every unit must be FNSKU-labelled at the factory (Amazon US ended prep and labelling services on 1 Jan 2026)	Best once demand is proven
Factory → destination 3PL → FBA replenishment	Bulk stock sits in a 3PL; FBA topped up every 2–4 weeks	Avoids aged-stock surcharges and inbound limits; supports several marketplaces from one landing	Extra 3PL storage and handling; second inbound freight leg	Recommended for launch
Small test shipments (air or LCL)	300–800 units by air or LCL to test conversion	Proves demand before a full container	Air freight is several times ocean cost per kg; thin margin	Use for the first 60 days only

Importer of record: a Pakistani company can act as non-resident importer in the US (CBP Form 5106, US agent, bond, licensed broker), but Executive Order 14411 (3 Jun 2026) directs CBP to tighten rules for foreign importers, possibly barring continuous bonds. A US LLC or a third-party importer of record is the safer route. Canada allows non-resident importers but, under CARM, they must post their own security. The UK needs a GB EORI, UK VAT registration and postponed VAT accounting so import VAT is cash-neutral.

Compliance by country (from background regulation; not verified live):

Requirement	US	Canada	UK
Fibre content and origin label	FTC Textile Act: generic fibre %, “Made in Pakistan”, RN or company name	Bilingual English/French fibre content, CA identification number	Textile Products (Labelling and Fibre Composition) Regulations 2012
“Bamboo” claims	Must read “rayon/viscose made from bamboo”; FTC fined Kohl’s and Walmart $5.5M in 2022	Competition Bureau: viscose/rayon disclosure	“Bamboo” is not a permitted fibre name; state “viscose”
Care label	16 CFR 423	Care labelling (voluntary symbols standard)	Voluntary but expected
Flammability	Sheets and duvet covers: none. Mattress pads and filled protectors/toppers: 16 CFR 1632	Textile Flammability Regulations	Furniture and Furnishings Fire Regulations cover mattresses, pillows and fillings, not sheets or duvet covers
Chemicals	California Prop 65; state PFAS bans in textiles (CA, ME, MN, CO, VT)	CCPSA general prohibition	UK REACH (azo dyes, SVHC)
Children’s bedding	CPSIA testing and certificate	CCPSA	GPSR
Market access	Amazon product-safety documents; OEKO-TEX optional but useful	Amazon.ca documents	UK responsible person; EU GPSR applies in Northern Ireland

Timing and cash (ASSUMPTION until the factory confirms): production 30–45 days for a new construction after sample approval, ocean 25–35 days to the US West Coast or UK and 35–45 days to the US East Coast or Canada, then 10–20 days for clearance and FBA check-in. With 60–90 days of selling and a 14-day Amazon payout cycle, cash is tied up for roughly 140–200 days per cycle.

Sources: US HTS 6302.31.90 rate · US HTS 6302.32.20 · Section 301 Pakistan tariff summary · MPF FY2027 · Canada Customs Tariff ch. 63, 2026 · UK DCTS preference tiers · Care Labeling Rule.

Additional operating points [Study B, R10–R28]. Pakistan export runs through the PSW Single Declaration with commercial invoice, packing list, HS classification and origin evidence. UK DCTS rules-of-origin changes took effect on 1 January 2026; check HS 6302 versus 9404 and Great Britain versus Northern Ireland treatment. In the US, distinguish flat textile bedding from mattress pads (16 CFR 1632/1633 apply by product classification, not name) and review cotton traceability under UFLPA. Planning lead times: production 30–60 days, ocean and end-to-end 30–60 days, customs and receiving 7–21 days. QC plan: approved golden sample, fibre/weight/construction checks, repeated-wash dimensions, pilling/abrasion, colour-fastness, seams and closures, protector leak tests at an accredited lab. Reorder point = expected daily orders × replenishment days + safety stock. Separate the factory, exporter, importer of record, marketplace seller and fulfilment provider in contracts; Amazon or a 3PL does not become importer of record by default.

Lessons from the existing account and what transfers

The account proves we can run a large bedding business on Amazon, but most of its margin comes from one product with years of reviews; the evidence that best predicts a new brand is our second brand, Sleephoria, and our recent launches — and those mostly lost money.

Proven internal findings (ACTUAL, Jan–Oct 2026 unless noted):

- **One profit engine.** Decolure bamboo sets made $715k net on $4.28M US sales (16.7%); the whole US account made $430k. Everything else, in aggregate, lost money.
- **High-price sets carry the margin.** Bamboo ($78 ASP) and Sleephoria cooling ($67 ASP) earn 16.7% and 19.5% net; satin ($31 ASP) earns 0% to −12% after fees and ads.
- **A second brand pays a 5–9 point TACoS penalty.** Sleephoria satin runs 22.4% TACoS against Decolure's 16.9%; Sleephoria bamboo 21.9% against 12.7%. Both lose money on the same products and factory.
- **Strong CTR does not rescue weak conversion.** Sleephoria's quilt set had 1.9× the market click-through rate but 0.8× its conversion (SLQS audit, Aug 2026); at 3.0% ad conversion and $44.99 price against a $31 benchmark it lost about $20k a month.
- **Paid velocity does not stick on its own.** Decolure's bamboo fitted sheet fell from 45–67 orders a week to 4–7 once spend was cut from ~$500 to ~$70 a week.
- **Broad colour ranges create aged stock.** 16,907 units are over 180 days old; Sleephoria satin carries 70 SKUs with aged stock; the top six colours carry 56% of bamboo units.
- **Light colours return more.** Refunds run 1.3–2.5 points higher on light shades in sheets, and 10.4 points higher in quilts.
- **Bulky products fail on fees.** The quilt set's 0.70 cu ft box drove $11.81 FBA plus storage surcharges three times those of satin.
- **Ads efficiency is falling.** US conversion fell from 15.0% to 11.1% and TACoS rose from 9.9% to 15.2% year on year while clicks rose 65%. Ranking-objective campaigns ran at 43% ACoS.
- **Broad and phrase beat exact on cost.** Broad: $12.09 per order at 23.9% ACoS; exact: $20.02 at 42.4%.

Reasonable hypotheses (not yet proven):

- Price and review mass, not listing quality, separated our quilt from the leaders; a price at or below the segment median would have converted better.
- The year-on-year fall in US sales is driven by competition and lost share (our bamboo purchase share fell from 6.6% to 2.2% while bamboo searches grew 11%), not by demand.
- Canada's higher share for our brands reflects a thinner competitive field rather than a better product.

Questions that still need a test: whether cotton converts at bamboo-like rates for our customers; how much an OEKO-TEX or "tested fit" claim lifts conversion; and price elasticity at $55 versus $65 versus $75 for a cotton set.

Transferability to a new brand:

Lesson	Transfers?	Why
Unit-economics structure (fees, refund rates, landed-cost uplift)	Yes	Same factory logic, same Amazon fee schedule
Keep SKUs to 4–6 colours × 3 sizes; prefer dark/mid shades	Yes	Driven by customer behaviour, not brand
Avoid bulky categories (quilts, comforters) at launch	Yes	Fee structure applies to everyone
Broad/phrase-led discovery, no blanket top-of-search premium	Yes	Auction mechanics are the same
Account conversion of 11% and $16 per order	No	Depends on review mass and ranking history; a new brand starts at about half the conversion
Bamboo's 16.7% net margin	No	Built on years of reviews and rank; a new brand would compete against Decolure itself
Canada share of 24–28%	Partly	Market is thin for everyone, but our share took years to build
Team, PPC tooling, SOPs, supplier relationships	Yes	Operational capability is the real advantage the new brand inherits

Alternative worth weighing: launching the cotton line under the existing Decolure brand would avoid the measured second-brand penalty. It would not answer the new-brand question as asked, and it concentrates risk on one brand, so it is kept as a fallback if the new brand fails its month-4 gate.

Customer demand, complaints and unmet needs

The problems a mill can fix with specification and QC are shrinkage, pocket fit, pilling, colour accuracy and slippery satin — and our own refund data shows colour mismatch is the most expensive of them. Review text could not be collected (Amazon blocked automated access), so complaint themes are qualitative, ranked by how many independent tests or summaries raised them; our refund rates are measured.

What buyers search for (EST, Data Dive monthly US search volume at each niche's research date): generic size-led terms dominate — "king size sheets set" 327k, "queen sheets" 205k, "duvet cover" 504k, "silk pillowcase" 120k. Material terms are smaller: "bamboo sheets" 205–342k, "silk sheets" 133k, "cotton sheets" 97k, "100% cotton sheets" 71k, "satin sheets" 78k, "linen sheets" 58k, "percale sheets king size" 15k, "sateen sheets" 6k, "egyptian cotton sheets queen" 5k. Year to date, Brand Analytics shows "queen sheets" up 54%, bamboo up 11%, cooling down 11% and satin down 17% against the same weeks of 2025.

Complaint themes by construction (qualitative, 55 US products, 2.78M listing ratings):

Construction	Main complaints	Specification that fixes it	Fixable by a mill?
Cotton percale	Shrinkage leaves fitted pocket too shallow; pilling after 1–2 years; crisp feel; wrinkles	Pre-shrunk/garment-washed long-staple single-ply yarn; 15–16" pocket with all-round elastic sized 2–3" over the mattress	Yes
Cotton sateen	Wrinkles; sleeps warm; pillowcases slide off	300–400 TC single-ply rather than inflated thread count; envelope pillowcases	Yes
Viscose from bamboo	Pills in the first year; loose seams; heat despite "cooling" claims; doubts about fibre content	Higher-GSM twill, double-stitched seams, honest "viscose from bamboo" label, OEKO-TEX	Partly
Polyester microfiber	Traps heat; pills; static; thin and bunches	Double-brushed ≥ 90 GSM, anti-pill finish	Partly (commodity)
Polyester satin	Sheets and pillows slide off; loose	Corner straps plus all-round	Yes

Construction	Main complaints	Specification that fixes it	Fixable by a mill?
	elastic; snags	elastic; heavier charmeuse	
Linen	Sheds lint; scratchy at first; fit changes after washing	Stonewashed, pre-shrunk flax; shrink allowance	Yes, if flax is sourced
Duvet cover sets	Zip snags; colour bleed on first wash; cotton wrinkles	Eight corner ties, hidden quality zip, colour-fast dyeing	Yes
Quilt sets	Thinner than expected; colour differs from photos	State GSM and weight; true-colour photography	Yes
Waterproof mattress protectors	Crinkle noise; sleeps hot; waterproofing fades	TPU membrane, terry/jersey top, deep skirt	Needs laminated fabric

What our own refunds say (ACTUAL, Sellerboard, US, Jan–Oct 2026):

- Light colours refund more in every family: bamboo 7.5% vs 6.2% for dark/mid shades, satin 7.5% vs 5.0%, cooling 6.8% vs 5.0%, quilts 16.3% vs 5.9%.
- The SLQS audit traced the quilt refund wave to shade perception: Light Grey arrived darker than shown and Sage lighter, and those SKUs refunded at 20–27%.
- Queen and King are 80% of bamboo units and 80% of satin units; Twin refunds the most (7.2–8.6%).
- Demand concentrates in a few colours: the top six colours carry 56% of bamboo units across 331 bamboo SKUs. White alone is 19.5% of bamboo; black is 20.6% of satin.

Unmet needs worth testing (not yet validated): a pre-washed, pre-shrunk cotton percale set with a measured, labelled pocket depth; cotton sateen that is honest about thread count; satin with corner straps; and colour-calibrated photography with a stated colour tolerance. Willingness to pay is untested; the price evidence in the next sections shows where demand already sits.

Sources: themes compiled from Consumer Reports, Good Housekeeping, Sleep Foundation, Which? test methods and retailer summaries via search extracts (26 Oct 2026); review counts and prices from Data Dive niche snapshots (Jun 2025 – Oct 2026).

Coded review sample [Study B]. Automated topic coding of 122 review cards (one review can match several themes; counts are topic mentions, not complaint rates):

Reviewer country	Reviews	Comfort/softness	Fit/sizing	Durability/pilling	Shrinkage
US (imported on CA/UK pages)	25	17	10	2	1
Canada	40	25	22	4	1
UK	33	18	13	2	0

Examples: a Canadian THREAD SPREAD review (14 Aug 2026) — “Pockets were not deep enough. Ask for 18” pocket got 15”“; a Canadian Utopia protector review questioning a”bamboo” impression where the page discloses 80% polyester / 20% viscose; a UK Sapphire duvet review (18 Dec 2025) reporting first-wash dye transfer; a Canadian Sasttie Vine review praising orientation tags and elastic straps. Fit/sizing appears in 40–55% of reviews in every country sample, which supports making a verified post-wash fit the core product claim.

Final product shortlist

Start with one product — a pre-washed 100% cotton percale sheet set in the US — and add a cotton waffle duvet cover and Canada only after it passes the month-4 gate. Ranked by risk-adjusted attractiveness, not volume.

	1. P1 Cotton percale set · US	2. P2 Cotton waffle duvet set · US	3. P3 Cotton percale set · Canada	4. P4 UK cotton duvet set + fitted sheet
When	Launch first	Month 4–5, if P1 passes its gate	Month 4–6, same SKUs	Test in months 9–12, only if the US is validated

	1. P1 Cotton percale set · US	2. P2 Cotton waffle duvet set · US	3. P3 Cotton percale set · Canada	4. P4 UK cotton duvet set + fitted sheet
Target customer	Hot sleepers and microfiber up-graders wanting real cotton at $55–70, not $159 DTC	Same buyer, completing the bed; design-led, textured look	Same as US; CAD 85–95	UK buyer of fitted sheet + duvet set in cotton, £20–45
Material and construction	100% long-staple combed cotton percale, 250–300 TC single-ply, garment-washed and pre-shrunk	100% cotton waffle weave, pre-washed; hidden zip; 8 corner ties	As P1, bilingual labels	200–300 TC cotton percale; 35–40 cm pocket fitted sheet
Sizes and colours	Full, Queen, King × White, Stone, Slate Grey, Navy (4 colours, 12 SKUs); avoid pale greens and pinks at launch	Queen, King × White, Oat, Charcoal (6 SKUs)	Queen, King, Full × the best 3 US colours	Double, King, Super King × White, Grey, Navy
Set configuration	Flat + fitted (16” pocket, all-round elastic, corner labels) + 2 pillowcases	Cover + 2 shams	As P1	Duvet cover + 2 pillowcases; fitted sheet sold separately
Target retail price	$59.99 / $64.99 / $69.99 (blended $66.49)	$74.99 / $79.99	CAD 84.99 / 89.99 / 94.99	£34.99 / 39.99 / 44.99
Main competitor products	LANE LINEN, MooMee, California Design Den, K MASANIJI	Bedsure waffle, PHF, David’s Home	Hotel-style unbranded sets, Amazon Basics, CGK	Utopia, Catherine Lansfield, Dreamscene, Yard, Amazon Basics
Differentiation	Tested fit after 5 washes printed on pack and listing; OEKO-TEX; honest TC; mill-direct story	Price below Bedsure’s $84–90 with 100% cotton	Lower competition, bilingual pack	Cotton at polycotton prices; 0% duty
Demand and positioning	Pre-washed niche ~$4.5M/month (upper bound); mid-premium	Waffle niche ~$2.8M/month; mid	~8% of US volume; mid	Unmeasured; mid
Initial inventory	2,500 units (base); 1,500 low; 4,000 high	600–900 units	500–800 units	600–1,000 units
Landed cost per unit	$20.34	$25.90	CAD 28.05	£10.33
Contribution before ads / margin	$19.84 / 29.8%	$21.79 / 28.1%	CAD 25.96 / 28.4%	£8.23 / 21.1%
Launch ad budget (first 90 days)	$35k base ($20–45k)	$10–15k	CAD 10–15k	£10–15k
Break-even condition	ACoS < 29.8% per order; mature TACoS ≤ 18% for a 10%+ margin	ACoS < 28.1%	ACoS < 28.4%	ACoS < 21.1% — hard
Key risks	Review barrier on generic terms; 10% tariff; shrinkage QC	Bedsure dominance; bulky box	Small volume; CARM security	VAT; Utopia price war; separate SKUs
Factory capability needed	Percale weaving, garment wash, cut-and-sew, FNSKU labelling, AATCC lab tests	Dobby/waffle looms	Bilingual labelling	UK sizes, UK labelling
Confidence	Medium	Medium–low	Medium	Low
Evidence	Niche review barrier 492; 73% of rivals < 500 reviews; cotton is Pakistan’s core export; 4.7-point duty advantage over viscose	Niche median 131 reviews; “duvet cover” 504k searches	Our CA share 24–28%; CA review barrier 522	Research only; 0% DCTS duty

Why P1 beats the strongest alternative (bamboo): bamboo earns more per unit on our account (37% break-even versus 29.8%), but a new brand would pay ~$6.43 suggested CPC, face a median 2,782 reviews, risk Chinese-fabric origin and compete directly against Decolure, our own profit engine. Cotton is where the mill’s advantage is real and where the US duty is lower.

Avoid or postpone, and why:

Product	Decision	Reason
Viscose-from-bamboo sets	Avoid in the new brand	Cannibalises Decolure; CPC $6.43; origin and FTC labelling risk
Polyester satin sets	Avoid	$26 median price; our satin earns ~0% net; 4,704 median reviews
Microfiber generic sets	Avoid	Price war led by CGK (443k reviews) and Utopia; FOB floor $3.90–7.50
Quilt sets and comforters	Postpone	Bulky FBA fees and storage; our quilt lost ~$20k/month
Mattress toppers	Avoid	Not a textile line; oversize fees; flammability testing
Waterproof mattress protectors	Postpone	Median 6,073 reviews; needs TPU-laminated fabric
Linen sets	Postpone	Flax must be imported; small demand
Silk pillowcases	Avoid	Not a Pakistani core fibre
Cooling sheets	Postpone	Our own CooLinens launch pays $41 per order; seasonal

Parallel B2B track (from Study B's O1). UK hospitality / private-label white cotton-rich linen: no Amazon CAC, repeat replacement demand and 0% DCTS duty, but long sampling cycles, customer concentration, credit terms and quality-claim risk. Action: send sample packs and quote-backed cost-per-use proposals to two or three UK hotel-linen buyers or laundries during Stage 0; no inventory until a buyer accepts samples and terms. Monitoring: wash-cycle performance, landed quote, buyer target price, sample approvals, payment terms and reorder intent.

Launch strategy and roadmap

Run the launch in four gated phases: validate the product and the numbers first (weeks 1–6), go live with a small air-freighted batch for reviews (around week 12), land the main stock and spend the ad budget only after the samples pass, then expand to the duvet line and Canada after a month-4 gate. Dates assume a decision on 2 Nov 2026; every date after week 6 depends on sample approval, mill lead time, Amazon brand approval and freight schedules.

Phase 1 — Validation (weeks 1–6): factory cost sheets for 3 sizes; pre-production samples in 4 colours; package measurements and weights; AATCC/ASTM tests for shrinkage, pilling and colour-fastness; OEKO-TEX application; freight, broker and importer-of-record quotes; Amazon FBA fee previews on real dimensions; trademark filing. Go/no-go criteria are in the decision memo.

Phase 2 — Initial launch (weeks 7–20): US marketplace only; 12 SKUs; 2,500 units base. Price at $59.99 / $64.99 / $69.99 with a 10% launch coupon for 4–6 weeks. Listings built around the tested-fit claim, 7+ images, video and A+ content. Campaigns: auto + broad/phrase discovery, exact on size and long-tail terms, brand defence once the brand is indexed; daily budget guardrails and a weekly review using the account's oversight system.

Phase 3 — Optimisation (months 4–6): move spend to the search terms that convert at ≤ $25 per order; negate terms with ≥ 2× target cost per order and no sales; test price at $64.99 versus $69.99 on King; refresh images where conversion lags; read refunds by colour every two weeks.

Phase 4 — Expansion (months 6–12): reorder when cover falls below lead time plus 45 days; add the waffle duvet set; list in Canada; consider one extra colour only if a colour sells > 20% of units; decide on a UK test at month 9 against the gate criteria.

First 90 days, week by week (from decision):

Week	Actions	Output / gate
1	Approve brief; mill quotes FOB by size; request 4-colour samples; file US trademark (classes 24, 20); open US LLC or appoint importer of record	Cost sheet requested; trademark serial number
2	Book lab tests; request freight, broker, bond and 3PL quotes; brand name and packaging design brief	Quotes requested
3	Receive samples; measure and weigh packed units; run FBA fee previews; draft listing copy and keyword map	Real FBA fee per size
4	Lab tests running (shrinkage after 3 and 5 washes, pilling, colour-fastness); photography plan	—
5	Lab results; finalise FOB; rebuild the unit-economics model with real inputs	Contribution before ads ≥ 25% at target price?
6	**Gate 1: go/no-go on production**; issue PO for 2,500 units plus 300 units for air freight	PO or stop
7–8	Production starts; packaging and FNSKU labels printed at the mill; Brand Registry once the trademark is filed	Brand Registry application
9	Pre-production photography and video on approved samples; build listings, A+ and brand store	Listings ready
10	Air-ship 300 units (best 6 SKUs); enrol Vine (up to 30 units)	Inbound shipment created
11–12	300 units live; Vine reviews; auto and broad campaigns at $150–250/day; weekly conversion read	First conversion read on 500+ clicks
12–13	Third-party inspection of the main batch; ocean booking; ISF filed 24 h before loading	Main batch ships; arrival ~week 18–20

6-month view (to about May 2027): main stock live around weeks 18–20; full $35k 90-day ad budget runs from that point; **Gate 2 at month 4 of selling** (conversion ≥ 8%, refunds ≤ 7%, contribution after ads ≥ $0 per unit on a 4-week basis); first reorder placed by month 3–4 of selling; waffle duvet samples approved.

12-month view (to about Nov 2027): Prime Day 2027 and the summer cotton season as the first scale test; Canada live on the same SKUs; duvet set live; UK test decided at month 9; Black Friday 2027 stocked from a reorder placed by early August 2027.

Financial scenarios and capital required

The base case needs about $142k of peak cash (including 15% contingency), earns $537k revenue and $29k contribution after ads in the first 12 months, and recovers its one-time launch costs in month 12. The conservative case loses $26k and should trigger the stop rule; the upside earns $135k. All figures are model outputs (CALC) from the inputs labelled in the economics section.

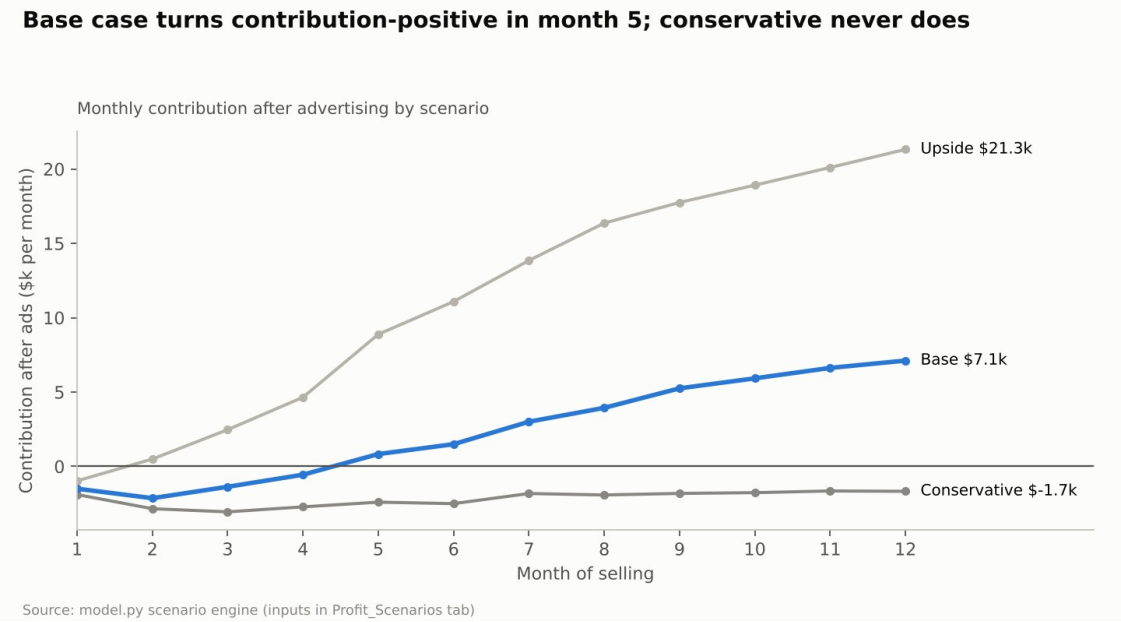


Figure 12. Base case turns contribution-positive in month 5; conservative never does

Source: Study A · model.py scenario engine.

12 months from first sale	Conservative	Base	Upside
Daily sheet-set sales, month 1 → 12	2 → 12	3 → 27	4 → 46
Units (sheets + duvets)	2,970	7,875	12,921
Revenue	$195k	$537k	$883k
Conversion, month 1 → 12	6.0% → 8.0%	7.0% → 10.0%	8.0% → 12.0%
Average CPC	$2.80	$2.40	$2.10
Organic share of units, month 1 → 12	8% → 30%	10% → 45%	15% → 55%
Ad spend / TACoS	$83k / 42.6%	$129k / 24.0%	$125k / 14.2%
Contribution after ads	−$26k	+$29k	+$135k
One-time launch costs	$14.5k	$27.0k	$40.0k
Initial inventory (landed)	1,500 units / $30.5k	2,500 / $50.8k	4,000 / $81.3k
Reorders placed	2	3	4
Peak cash need incl. contingency	$96k	$142k	$197k
One-time costs recovered	not within 12 months	month 12	month 7
Inventory left at month 12	1,530 units	990 units	1,350 units

Launch budget for the test (one product family, US):

Item	Low	Base	High	Type
Initial inventory, landed (incl. freight, duty, insurance)	$30.5k	$50.8k	$81.3k	Working capital
Samples and lab testing (incl. OEKO-TEX)	$3.0k	$6.0k	$9.0k	One-time
Branding, packaging design, trademarks	$3.0k	$5.0k	$7.0k	One-time
Photography, video, A+ content	$3.0k	$6.0k	$10.0k	One-time
Listing preparation and localisation	$1.0k	$1.5k	$2.0k	One-time

Item	Low	Base	High	Type
Importer of record, bond, broker, 3PL set-up	$2.5k	$4.5k	$6.0k	One-time
Vine and launch coupons	$2.0k	$4.0k	$6.0k	Launch expense
PPC, first 90 days	$20.0k	$35.0k	$45.0k	Launch expense
Contingency	10% — $6.5k	15% — $16.9k	20% — $33.3k	Reserve
Capital to test	**$71.5k**	**$129.7k**	**$199.6k**	

Amazon referral, FBA, storage and returns are paid out of each sale and are inside the unit economics, not the budget. Replenishment is funded from sales plus the reserve; the base case places its first reorder (2,500 units, ~$51k) in month 4.

Capital to scale (months 6–18, if the gates pass): about $200–350k more — 4 months of inventory cover for roughly 1,500 to 2,000 units a month across P1 and P2 (about $130–170k), Canada launch ($35–60k incremental), a UK test if approved ($60–90k) and a higher ad envelope during Prime Day and Q4.

What moves the result most: conversion and organic share drive the gap between scenarios more than any cost line. On unit economics, price (±10% = ±$5.09 per unit) and factory FOB (±15% = ±$3.13) matter most, then refunds and freight. Each $0.40 change in CPC at 8% conversion moves cost per order by $5.

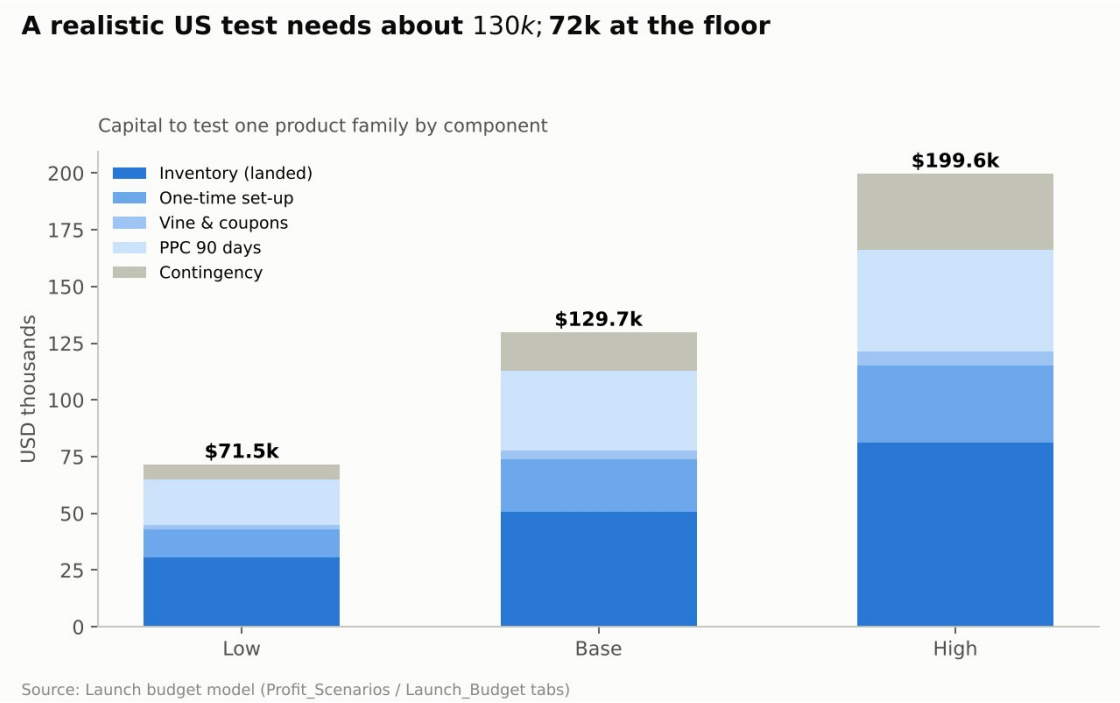


Figure 13. A realistic US test needs about $130k; $72k at the floor (Study A)

Source: Study A · launch budget model.

Study B's illustrative launch cash [Study B]. Low / medium / high: US $8.9k / $55.0k / $195.0k; Canada CAD 10.3k / 67.7k / 246.0k; UK £7.9k / 43.4k / 158.7k. These include 200 / 800 / 2,400 initial units, a 30% next-order deposit, set-up of 1,500 / 6,000 / 20,000, ad budgets of 2,000 / 8,000 / 25,000, three months of overhead, a tax float and a 15% reserve. All high cases lose contribution at their assumed CPC and conversion, and the UK low case does too — more capital cannot rescue negative unit economics. Study A's base ($130k) carries more

inventory (2,500 units) and a larger ad budget ($35k) because it is sized to reach a review base in the 12-SKU US launch.

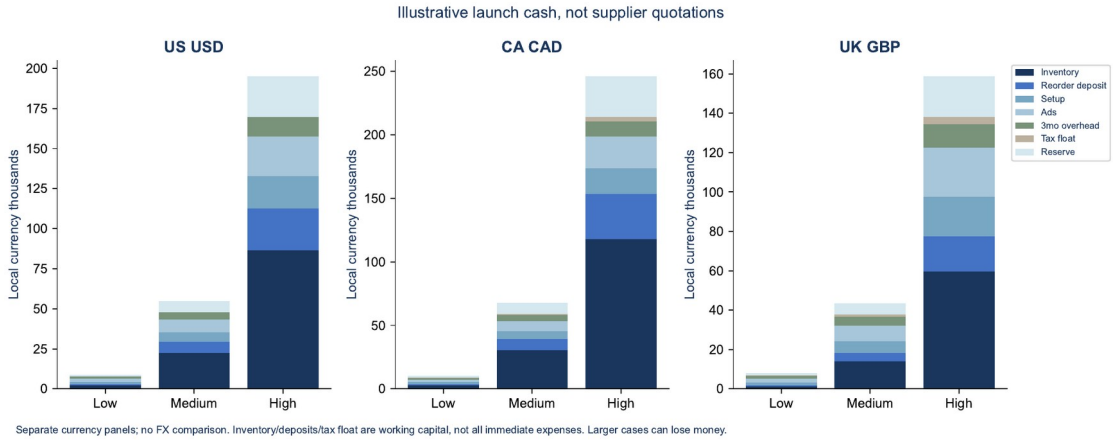


Figure 14. Study B illustrative launch cash by marketplace (not supplier quotations)

Source: Study B · economics workbook; separate currency panels.

Risk register

The risks most likely to make the business unprofitable are low new-brand conversion, ad costs above break-even, overstock and the US tariff — in that order. Likelihood and impact are judgements (H/M/L) from the evidence cited.

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Evidence	Mitigation	Early warning metric	Owner
1	New-brand conversion stays below 7%, so ads never reach break-even	M	H	CooLinens 8.2%; Sleephoria quilt 3.0%; account fell from 15.0% to 11.1%	Tested-fit claim, Vine, price at or below segment median, small colour range	Conversion on first 1,500 clicks	Brand manager
2	Ad spend per order stays above $30 (ACoS > break-even 29.8%)	H	H	Cotton suggested CPC $2.21–2.64; exact $2.72 on our account	Broad/phrase-led discovery, long-tail exact, no blanket top-of-search premium	Weekly cost per order	PPC lead
3	Overstock and aged-inventory surcharges	M	H	16,907 aged units; $15.9k/month surcharge on our account	2,500-unit first order, 4 colours, 3PL buffer, reorder on cover	Days of cover > 150	Supply planner
4	10% Section 301 tariff persists or rises; new “excess capacity” actions	M	M	In force since 24 Jul 2026; CIT ruling pending	Price for 16.7%; keep entries open for refunds; model the 1.31× upside	CIT ruling; Federal Register	Finance
5	Importer-of-record rules for foreign companies (EO 14411)	M	M	Deadline reported ~30 Nov 2026	US LLC or third-party importer of record	CBP guidance	Finance / legal
6	Shrinkage or pilling leads to	M	H	Consumer Reports: cotton	AATCC 135 / ASTM D3512	Refund rate > 7%; 1–2★	QC lead

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Evidence	Mitigation	Early warning metric	Owner
	returns and poor reviews			shrinks up to 6%; our bamboo refunds 7.2%	tests on every batch; pre-shrunk fabric	reviews mentioning fit	
7	Colour mismatch returns	M	M	Light quilt colours refunded 20–27%	Calibrated photography, colour tolerance in the spec, few light colours	Refunds by colour	Brand manager
8	Fabric origin not Pakistani (sourced greige from China)	L	H	Origin follows weaving; would trigger China duties and lose UK 0%	Weave in-house; keep mill records	Supplier audit	Factory
9	Incumbents cut price or flood ads (LANE LINEN, MooMee, Bedsure)	M	M	Strike-through pricing; top-3 shares of 85–90% in the target niches	Compete on spec and fit, not price; protect margin floor	Buy-box price index	Brand manager
10	New brand cannibalises or is confused with Decolure	L	M	Same account, overlapping keywords	Cotton only; negate cross-brand terms	Shared search-term overlap	PPC lead
11	FTC or Amazon claims action (“cooling”, “organic”, thread count)	L	M	FTC bamboo penalties 2022	No cooling or bamboo claims; certify before claiming organic	Listing suppressions	Compliance
12	Freight disruption (Red Sea routing, rate spikes)	M	M	Freight not yet quoted	3PL buffer; quote two forwarders	Freight index; transit time	Supply planner
13	Cash tied up longer than planned (140–200 day cycle)	M	M	Lead-time assumptions unconfirmed	Air-freight starter batch; staged POs	Peak cash vs plan	Finance
14	UK expansion adds VAT, compliance and SKU complexity for thin margin	M	M	UK contribution £8.23 (21%)	Do not enter UK until US passes gates	UK test gate	GM

Additional risks from Study B. Demand extrapolation from publisher totals (high); price and rank sampling bias from overseas delivery destinations (high); advertising and cash burn without a bedding-specific country CPC (high — Study A’s internal data narrows this); claims risk where “cooling”, “organic” or “linen-like” wording outruns evidence; customer concentration and credit risk in the hospitality track.

Evidence-backed recommendations

Eight recommendations carry the decision; each is written so that its monitoring metric can prove it wrong.

#	Action	Reason	Evidence	Logic	Expected outcome	Monitoring	Risk that invalidates it
1	Build the new brand on 100% cotton percale, not bamboo,	Cotton is where the mill’s advantage is real and the	Pre-washed niche median 492 reviews (73% < 500);	Lower barrier + lower duty (16.7% vs 21.4%) + mill fit	29.8% break-even ACoS with a credible path to 18%	Conversion and cost per order in the first 1,500–3,000	Cotton conversion < 6%

#	Action	Reason	Evidence	Logic	Expected outcome	Monitoring	Risk that invalidates it
	satin or microfiber	review barrier is beatable	bamboo CPC $6.43 and 2,782 reviews; satin earns ~0% net on our account; Pakistan's $3.1bn bed-wear exports are cotton-led	beats higher bamboo margin that a new brand cannot reach	margin at maturity	clicks	
2	Launch in the US first, Canada 4–6 months later on the same SKUs, UK only after the US passes	The US has the demand; Canada is a cheap add-on; the UK needs new SKUs for thin margin	US ~12× Canada search volume; CA review barrier 522; UK contribution £8.23 (21%) after VAT	Prove scalability where demand is; add markets that reuse assets	One validated market by month 4; two by month 9	Gate 2 metrics; CA ACoS vs 28.4% break-even	US gate fails; CA proves easier and should lead
3	Launch only 12 SKUs (3 sizes × 4 colours), mostly mid and dark shades	Wide grids create aged stock and light colours refund more	16,907 aged units; top 6 colours = 56% of bamboo units; light shades refund 1.3–2.5 points more	Concentrate stock where demand is, cut return risk	Aged stock < 10% of units at 180 days	Units by colour; refunds by colour	One colour outsells by > 20% and stocks out
4	Make "tested fit after 5 washes" the core claim, backed by lab results	Shrinkage and pocket fit are the top cotton complaints and are fixable at the mill	Consumer Reports: cotton shrinks up to 6%; leaders state no measured post-wash depth	A verifiable spec beats adjectives and justifies a $60–70 price	Conversion ≥ 8%; refund rate ≤ 7%	Refund reasons mentioning fit; 1–2★ share	Amazon or FTC challenge to the claim wording
5	Price at $59.99 / $64.99 / $69.99 and test $74.99 King after month 4	Mid-premium sits above the $39.99 pre-washed median but below $80 MooMee and $159 DTC	Price is the biggest profit lever (±10% = ± $5.09 per unit)	Highest price the evidence supports without needing review mass	Blended ASP ≥ $64	Conversion by size and price step	Conversion falls more than 15% per $5
6	Run broad/phrase-led discovery and exact on long-tail; no blanket top-of-search premium	Our exact and ranking campaigns are the least efficient	Broad $12.09 per order vs exact $20.02; ranking campaigns 43% ACoS; SLQS top-of-search cost 65% more per order	Buy the cheapest qualified clicks while reviews build	Cost per order ≤ $25 by month 3	Weekly cost per order by match type	Long-tail volume too thin to hit unit targets
7	Stage the capital: $72–130k to test, $200–350k to scale only after Gate 2	The conservative case loses money; staging caps the downside	Scenario model: conservative −$26k, base +$29k, upside +$135k in 12 months	Commit inventory and ads in proportion to evidence	Maximum loss in a failed test ≈ $50–70k after selling through stock	Cumulative contribution vs plan	Supplier MOQ forces a larger first order
8	Keep the cotton line out of Decolure, but hold "Decolure cotton" as the fallback	A second brand pays a measured penalty; the ask is a new brand	Sleephoria lines run 5–9 points higher TACoS than Decolure	Answer the new-brand question cleanly, keep a lower-risk route open	Clean read on new-brand economics	Gate 2 decision	New brand fails while cotton itself converts — then move it under Decolure

Decision memo — answers to the 14 brief questions

Decision: a conditional go. Enter Amazon US with a new, cotton-only brand, starting with one pre-washed percale sheet set, a capped test budget of about $130k, and hard gates at production (week 6) and at month 4 of selling. Do not commit scale capital, Canada or the UK until the month-4 gate passes.

1. **Is entering Amazon bedding from Pakistan commercially attractive?** Yes, selectively. The cost base works (a $66 cotton set earns $19.84 before ads, 29.8%), Pakistan is proven as a source (Utopia; our own lines), and US duty on cotton is lower than on viscose. It is not attractive in commodity microfiber or satin, where our own account earns about 0%.
2. **Which marketplace first?** The US: largest demand (about 12× Canada's searches), our operating knowledge and the beatable pre-washed cotton niche. Canada follows on the same SKUs; the UK waits.
3. **Which products and constructions?** 100% long-staple cotton percale, 250–300 TC single-ply, pre-washed and pre-shrunk, as a 4-piece set in Full, Queen and King; then a cotton waffle duvet cover set.
4. **Biggest competitive obstacles?** LANE LINEN and MooMee in pre-washed cotton (85% of niche revenue), California Design Den and CGK on generic cotton terms, Bedsure in waffle duvets (90%), and Utopia in the UK.
5. **How hard is visibility for a new brand?** Hard on head terms (median 2,453 reviews in cotton sets; $2.21–2.64 suggested CPC), manageable in the pre-washed long tail (median 492). Expect $20–45 of ads per order for 8–12 weeks and a 5–9 point TACoS penalty versus an established brand.
6. **Initial capital for a realistic test?** $72k low, **$130k base**, $200k high — inventory, samples, branding, creative, set-up, 90 days of ads and contingency.
7. **Additional capital to scale?** About $200–350k over months 6–18 for inventory cover, the duvet line, Canada, a possible UK test and peak-season ads.
8. **Target price and contribution margin?** $59.99 / $64.99 / $69.99 (blended about $66); 30% contribution before ads; 15–18% after ads at maturity (TACoS 12–15%).
9. **Advertising during validation and launch?** $35k for the first 90 days (range $20–45k), then $12–13k a month in the base case; 12-month TACoS about 24% in base.
10. **Differentiation needed beyond price?** A verified post-wash fit claim, OEKO-TEX, honest specs, colour-accurate images, a tight colour range and a mill-direct quality story. Without these the brand is a commodity entrant and the evidence says it fails.
11. **Risks that could make it unprofitable?** Conversion below 7%, cost per order above ~$30, overstock, the 10% US tariff persisting or rising, shrinkage-driven returns and an importer-of-record rule change.
12. **What must be validated before committing inventory?** Real FOB by size, measured package dimensions and FBA fees, lab results for shrinkage, pilling and colour-fastness, freight and broker quotes, importer-of-record route, and contribution before ads ≥ 25% at the target price.
13. **Go/no-go criteria:**

Gate	Go if all are true	Stop or rework if any is true
Gate 1 — production (week 6)	FOB within 10% of $14.53 blended; shrinkage ≤ 3% after 5 washes; pilling grade ≥ 3.5; landed cost ≤ $22; contribution before ads ≥ 25%	Contribution < 22%; fabric not woven in-house; FBA fee > $10.50 per set
Gate 2 — month 4 of selling	Conversion ≥ 8% on ≥ 3,000 clicks; refunds ≤ 7%; rating ≥ 4.3; cost per order ≤ $25; contribution after ads ≥ $0 over 4 weeks; organic share ≥ 25%	Conversion < 6%; refunds > 10%; cost per order > $35 with no downward trend
Gate 3 — month 9 (Canada and UK decision)	US TACoS ≤ 22%; organic share ≥ 35%; positive contribution 3 months running	US still below Gate 2 thresholds

14. **Next 30 days:**

- ☐ Approve the brief, brand-name shortlist and the $130k test envelope
- ☐ Mill: cost sheets for Full, Queen, King; 4-colour pre-production samples; confirm in-house weaving
- ☐ Book AATCC 135 shrinkage, ASTM D3512 pilling and colour-fastness tests; start OEKO-TEX
- ☐ Measure and weigh packed samples; run Amazon FBA fee previews
- ☐ Get two freight, broker and bond quotes; choose a US LLC or third-party importer of record
- ☐ File US trademarks (classes 24 and 20); prepare Brand Registry
- ☐ Rebuild the unit-economics model with real inputs and hold Gate 1
- ☐ Check the FBA New Selection Program enrolment deadline (reported as 31 Oct 2026) in Seller Central

Study B's ten final questions, answered in the consolidated view.

Question	Consolidated answer
Which country and segments?	US first for differentiated cotton percale; Canada as follow-on; UK for native-size duvet covers later and hospitality B2B in parallel
Hardest competitors?	CGK and Utopia (value), LANE LINEN, MooMee and California Design Den (cotton), Bedsure (duvets), SafeRest/Silentnight

Question	Consolidated answer
	(protectors), IKEA and Dunelm (retail anchors)
Competitive materials, specs and prices?	250–300 TC single-ply cotton percale, pre-washed, measured post-wash fit; $59.99–69.99 in the US
What makes entry difficult?	Ratings and trust, ad costs, low-price anchors, conversion, claim accuracy, stock fragmentation, returns, import and fulfilment rules
Capital and advertising?	Stage 0 about $10–20k; Stage 1 $55–130k (floor $72k for 12 SKUs); $20–45k ads in the first 90 days
Underserved needs?	Reliable post-wash fit, truthful fibre and layer communication, wash-durable colour, easy duvet fitting, replacement availability
Best channels?	Amazon US for the product test; DTC later for bundles and education; UK hospitality/private-label as a parallel B2B track
Main risks and profit constraints?	CPC/CVR, price erosion, refunds, tariff and VAT treatment, logistics, FX and working capital
Three to five opportunities?	US cotton percale; UK hospitality linen; US/UK cotton duvet covers; Canada cotton sheets; US replacement fitted/pillowcase bundles
What next before investing?	Supplier quotes, wash tests, matched incumbent comparison, broker/HS confirmation, domestic panels, then a governed pilot

Assumptions, evidence register and open inputs

Every number that drives the decision is listed here with its type and source; the ASSUMPTION rows are the ones to replace first.

Input	Value used	Type	Source / date	Replace with
Factory FOB, percale set Full / Queen / King	$13.00 / $14.00 / $15.50	ASSUMPTION	Vendor price guide, Karachi: 250TC combed percale $12.40–14.80 (search extract, 26 Oct 2026)	Mill cost sheet
Factory FOB, waffle duvet set Queen / King	$17.50 / $19.50	ASSUMPTION	No public benchmark found	Mill cost sheet
Freight + duty + brokerage uplift, US	×1.40 cotton, ×1.45 viscose/poly	ASSUMPTION anchored to ACTUAL	SLQS audit: landed 40–44% above unit cost (Aug 2026)	Forwarder and broker quotes
Uplift, Canada / UK	×1.38 / ×1.18	ASSUMPTION	Duty 17% / 0% plus freight	Quotes
US duty, cotton set / viscose or poly set	16.7% / 21.4%	EST	HTS 6302.31.90 / 6302.32.20 + 10% Section 301 (search extracts, 26 Oct 2026)	Licensed broker classification
Canada duty / UK duty	17% / 0% (DCTS)	EST	CBSA 2026 tariff ch. 63; UK Trade Tariff	Broker; DCTS origin check
Referral fee	15%	EST	Amazon Home & Kitchen; UK “Home Products” 8% band under £20 unconfirmed	Seller Central
FBA fee, sheet set	$8.80–9.20	ACTUAL proxy	Our bamboo 4-pc average $9.06 (26 Oct 2026)	Fee preview on measured samples
FBA fee, Canada / UK	CAD 12.60–13.00 / £4.40–4.90	ACTUAL proxy / EST	Our CA bamboo CAD 12.98 / UK tier tables (garbled extract)	Fee previews
Refund rate	6.5% US, 7.5% CA, 5% UK	ACTUAL proxy	Our sheet families 5.4–7.2% (YTD 2026)	Live data
Launch CPC / conversion	$2.40 / 8% (range $1.80–3.00 / 7–9%)	CALC	Account $1.79 / 11.1%; Sleephoria and CooLinens launches; Data Dive suggested bids	First 1,500 clicks
Organic share at month 12	30% / 45% / 55% by scenario	ASSUMPTION	Mature account ~57% organic (ad sales $3.87M of ~$9.0M implied total)	Business reports

Input	Value used	Type	Source / date	Replace with
FX	USD/CAD 1.3993; GBP/USD 1.3367; USD/PKR 276.82	EST	Bank of Canada / SBP, 23–26 Oct 2026	Treasury rate at PO
Rival units and revenue	Sales-rank brackets and Data Dive estimates	EST	Roster 25 Oct 2026; Data Dive Mar–Oct 2026; upper bounds	—
Market sizes	US $8.6–10.9bn; CA ~$1.37bn; UK ~$3.5bn bed linen	EST	Mordor, FMI, Grand View, ECDB (report-level estimates)	—

Open inputs needed from the factory (in order): FOB by size and colour; fabric construction (count, TC, GSM) and consumption per set; garment-wash process and shrinkage results; packed carton and unit dimensions and weights; MOQ per colour and size; production lead time; which certifications the mill already holds (OEKO-TEX, BSCI, WRAP); and confirmation that fabric is woven in-house.

Data notes: Sellerboard calls the Sleephoria satin and bamboo listings “Sleep Sanctuary”; their ad spend matches Command Center’s Sleephoria products, so they are treated as one second brand here. Canada amounts are CAD in Command Center and USD in Sellerboard. A few SKUs carry obvious COGS errors in the economics feed (for example Queen Light Blue bamboo at $60.89 landed) and were excluded from averages. Review text and Amazon return-reason codes were not available; complaint themes are qualitative.

Source files behind this document: internal extracts and the scenario model are saved with the research workbook (see the repository branch for this study); external research notes carry a URL and access date for every figure.

Study B source key [accessed 26 Oct 2026]. M01–M03 Grand View Research home bedding US/CA/UK; M07–M09 Mordor home textiles US/UK/CA; R01 FTC textile labelling; R02 FTC bamboo textiles; R04 GOV.UK textile labelling; R07 CBSA import guide; R09 GOV.UK VAT rates; R10 GOV.UK importing goods; R11 CPSC mattress guidance; R12 PSW single declaration export; R19 Canada Textile Labelling and Advertising Regulations; R22–R25 GOV.UK DCTS tiers, claiming preferences and rules of origin; R26 CBSA Customs Tariff 2026 ch. 63; R27 USITC HTS; R28 CBP forced labour/UFLPA; C11 Gul Ahmed; C12 Nishat Mills; C14 Welspun Living; D01 Brooklinen Classic Core sheet set; D06 IKEA UK duvet cover sets; D07 IKEA Canada sheets; F01–F03 sell.amazon.com / .ca / .co.uk pricing; DUNELM26 Dunelm annual report 2026; LIVE_ *query snapshots and PDP*_ detail captures (full URLs in the Study B workbook Sources tab and evidence archive).